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Inventor(s)	Park; Youngchoon et al.

Building system with smart entity personal identifying information (PII) masking

Abstract

A building system for operating a building and managing private building information includes a processing circuit configured to receive a request for information for a building entity of a building entity database. The processing circuit is configured to select one of the mask templates from the entity database based on access values associated with the requesting device and a relational link between the building entity and the mask templates, retrieve private information for the building entity in response to a reception of the request for the information, and generate a masked information data structure based on the private information and the one of the mask templates.

Inventors: Park; Youngchoon (Brookfield, WI), Sinha; Sudhi R. (Milwaukee, WI), Ploegert; Justin (Cudahy, WI)

Applicant: Johnson Controls Technology Company (Auburn Hills, MI)

Family ID: 1000008778217

Assignee: JOHNSON CONTROLS TECHNOLOGY COMPANY (Auburn Hills, MI)

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Primary Examiner: Brown; Anthony D

Attorney, Agent or Firm: Foley & Lardner LLP

Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED PATENT APPLICATIONS (1) This application is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/510,245 filed Oct. 25, 2021, which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/722,197 filed Dec. 20, 2019, which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/570,845, filed Sep. 13, 2019, which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/048,052, filed Jul. 27, 2018, which claims benefit of and priority to U.S. Provisional Patent Application No. 62/564,247, filed Sep. 27, 2017, U.S. Provisional Patent Application No. 62/611,984, filed Dec. 29,

BACKGROUND

(1) The present disclosure relates generally to a building management system and more particularly to building information management of a building management system that collects, manages, and protects data for interconnected devices and other entities. The present disclosure relates specifically to a building system configured to manage private information associated with a building.

(2) A building management system (BMS) is, in general, a system of devices configured to control, monitor, and manage equipment in and/or around a building or building area. A BMS can include, for example, an HVAC system, a security system, a lighting system, a fire alerting system, and any other system that is capable of managing building functions or devices, or any combination thereof. As the number of BMS devices used in various sectors increases, the amount of data being produced and collected has been increasing exponentially. Accordingly, effective analysis and information management of a plethora of collected data is desired.

SUMMARY

(3) One implementation of the present disclosure is a building system for operating a building and managing private building information. The building system includes a processing circuit configured to receive a request for information for a building entity of a building entity database, wherein the building entity database includes the building entity, mask templates, and a relational link between the building entity and the mask templates. The processing circuit is configured to select one of the mask templates from the entity database based on access values associated with the requesting device and the relational link between the building entity and the mask templates. The processing circuit is configured to retrieve private information for the building entity in response to a reception of the request for the information, and generate a masked information data structure based on the private information and the one of the mask templates.

(4) In some embodiments, the processing circuit is configured to operate one or more pieces of building equipment to operate the building based on the masked information data structure.

(5) In some embodiments, the processing circuit is configured to select the one of the mask templates by selecting the one of the mask templates based on the access values.

(6) In some embodiments, each of the mask templates is associated with a particular combination of values of the access values. In some embodiments, the processing circuit is configured to select the one of the mask templates by selecting the one of the mask templates based on the particular combination of values of the access values by identifying the one of the mask templates associated with the particular combination of the values of the access values.

(7) In some embodiments, the processing circuit is configured to determine whether the request for information is a request for the private information or a request for public information and retrieve the public information and provide the public information to the requesting device without masking in response to a determination that the request for information is the request for the public information. In some embodiments, the processing circuit is configured to retrieve the private information for the building entity in response to the reception of the request for the information and in response to a determination that the request for the information is the request for the private information. In some embodiments, the processing circuit is configured to generate the masked information data structure based on the retrieved private information and the selected one of the mask templates in response to the determination that the request for the information is the request for the private information.

(8) In some embodiments, the private information includes attributes of the building entity. In some embodiments, each of the mask templates includes masking operators, one of the masking operators associated with each of the attributes. In some embodiments, the masking operators include at least one of a masking operator configured to replace one or more values of a particular attribute with a particular masking character, a masking operator configured to show the particular attribute in the clear, a masking operator configured to show only a particular number of values of the attribute, or a masking operator configured to apply a particular encryption method on the particular attribute.

(9) In some embodiments, the access values include at least one of role information of a user of the requesting device, wherein the role information indicates a permission level of the user, a device type of

the requesting device, a geographic location of the requesting device, an application of the requesting device associated with generating the request for private information, or a vertical identifying a business use associated with the requesting device.

(10) In some embodiments, the processing circuit is configured to receive a mask template request from a second system, the second system configured to store the private information and mask the private information based on a mask template received from the building system, select a second mask template of the mask templates based on the mask template request received from the second system, and send the second mask template to the second system for masking, by the second system, the private information stored by the second system.

(11) In some embodiments, the processing circuit is configured to generate an access hash key based on the access values. In some embodiments, the processing circuit is configured to select the one of the mask templates from the entity database based on the access values by selecting the one of the mask templates with the access hash key. In some embodiments, each of the mask templates is associated with a particular value of the access hash key.

(12) In some embodiments, the processing circuit is configured to generate the access hash key by concatenating the access values and hashing the concatenated access values to generate the access hash key.

(13) In some embodiments, the processing circuit is configured to determine a transitive closure for the entity database based on a set of entities of the entity database and a set of relational links between entities of the set of entities, the set of entities including at least the building entity, the mask templates, and the private information and update the entity database based on the transitive closure by adding additional relational links between the entities of the set of entities, the additional relational links including at least one of the relational link between the building entity and the one or more mask templates and a relational link between the building entity and the private information. In some embodiments, the processing circuit is configured to retrieve the private information for the building entity in response to the reception of the request for the information based on the relational link between the building entity and the private information.

(14) In some embodiments, the processing circuit is configured to receive new entity data, the new entity data including at least one of a new building entity and a new link between the new building entity and at least one of the entities of the set of entities, new private information and a new link between the new private information and at least one of the entities of the set of entities, or new mask templates and a new link between the new mask templates and at least one of the entities of the set of entities, add the new entity data to the entity database, determine the transitive closure of the entity database based on the set of entities, the set of relational links, and the new entity data added to the entity database, and update the entity database by updating the set of relational links based on the transitive closure by adding new direct relational links between the entities of the set of entities to the set of relational links.

(15) In some embodiments, the building entity database includes a second building entity and one or more links relating the building entity to the second building entity and the second building entity to the building entity. In some embodiments, the processing circuit is configured to receive a second request for the private information for the building entity and second private information for the second entity linked to the building entity, determine whether a requesting device has access to the second private information of the second entity linked to the building entity and the private information of the building entity based on the access values, generate a second masked information data structure based on second private information and a second mask template, and provide the second masked information data structure to the requesting device in response the reception of the request for the private information and the second private information and in response to a determination that the requesting device has access to the second private information of the second entity linked to the building entity and the private information of the building entity based on the access values.

(16) In some embodiments, the building entity database includes one or more access control lists (ACL) linked to at least one of the building entity or the second building entity, wherein the one or more ACLs indicate whether a role indicated by the access values is associated with access to the second private information of the second building entity linked to the building entity and the private information of the building entity. In some embodiments, the processing circuit is configured to determine whether the requesting device has access to the second private information of the second building entity linked to the

building entity and the private information of the building entity based on the role indicated by the access values and the one or more ACLs.

(17) In some embodiments, the building entity database includes second mask templates and one or more links associating the second mask templates with the second building entity. In some embodiments, the processing circuit is configured to generate the second masked information data structure based on the second private information and the second mask template by selecting the second mask template from the second mask templates based on the access values and applying one or more masking operators of the second mask template to attributes of the second private information.

(18) In some embodiments, the first mask templates and the second mask templates are same mask templates.

(19) Another implementation of the present disclosure is a method for managing private information of smart entities of a smart entity database. The method includes receiving a request for information for a building entity of the building entity database from a requesting device, wherein the building entity database includes the building entity, mask templates, and the relational link between the building entity and the mask templates. The method includes selecting one of the mask templates from the entity database based on the access values associated with the requesting device and the relational link between the building entity and the mask templates. The method further includes retrieving private information for the building entity in response to a reception of the request for the information, generating a masked information data structure based on the private information and the one of the mask templates, and providing the masked information data structure to the requesting device in response to the reception of the request for the information.

(20) In some embodiments, selecting the one of the mask templates includes selecting the one of the mask templates based on the access values templates based on the particular combination of values of the access values by identifying the one of the mask templates associated with the particular combination of the values of the access values. In some embodiments, each of the mask templates is associated with a particular combination of values of the access values.

(21) In some embodiments, the private information includes attributes of the building entity. In some embodiments, each of the mask templates includes masking operators, one of the masking operators associated with each of the attributes. In some embodiments, the masking operators include at least one of a masking operator configured to replace one or more values of a particular attribute with a particular masking character, a masking operator configured to show the particular attribute in the clear, a masking operator configured to show only a particular number of values of the attribute, or a masking operator configured to apply a particular encryption method on the particular attribute.

(22) In some embodiments, the access values include at least one of role information of a user of the requesting device, wherein the role information indicates a permission level of the user, a device type of the requesting device, a geographic location of the requesting device, an application of the requesting device associated with generating the request for private information, or a vertical identifying a business use associated with the requesting device.

(23) In some embodiments, the building entity database includes a second building entity and one or more links relating the building entity to the second building entity and the second building entity to the building entity. In some embodiments, the method further includes receiving a second request for the private information for the building entity and second private information for the second entity linked to the building entity, determining whether the requesting device has access to the second private information of the second entity linked to the building entity and the private information of the building entity based on the access values, generating a second masked information data structure based on second private information and a second mask template, and providing the second masked information data structure to the requesting device in response the reception of the request for the private information and the second private information and in response to a determination that the requesting device has access to the second private information of the second entity linked to the building entity and the private information of the building entity based on the access values.

(24) In some embodiments, the building entity database includes one or more access control lists (ACL) linked to at least one of the building entity or the second building entity, wherein the one or more ACLs indicate whether a role indicated by the access values is associated with access to the second private information of the second building entity linked to the building entity and the private information of the

building entity. In some embodiments, the method further includes determining whether the requesting device has access to the second private information of the second building entity linked to the building entity and the private information of the building entity based on the role indicated by the access values and the one or more ACLs.

(25) In some embodiments, the building entity database includes second templates and one or more links associating the second mask templates with the second building entity. In some embodiments, generating the second masked information data structure based on the second private information and the second mask template include selecting the second mask template from the second mask templates based on the access values and applying one or more masking operators of the second mask template to attributes of the second private information.

(26) In some embodiments, the building entity database includes a second building entity and one or more links relating the building entity to the second building entity and the second building entity to the building entity. In some embodiments, the method further includes receiving a second request for the private information for the building entity and second private information for the second entity linked to the building entity, determining whether the requesting device has access to the second private information of the second entity linked to the building entity and the private information of the building entity based on the access values, generating a second masked information data structure based on second private information and a second mask template, and providing the second masked information data structure to the requesting device in response the reception of the request for the private information and the second private information and in response to a determination that the requesting device has access to the second private information of the second entity linked to the building entity and the private information of the building entity based on the access values.

(27) In some embodiments, the method includes determining a transitive closure for the entity database based on a set of entities of the entity database and a set of relational links between entities of the set of entities, the set of entities including at least the building entity, the mask templates, and the private information and updating the entity database based on the transitive closure by adding additional relational links between the entities of the set of entities, the additional relational links including at least one of the relational link between the building entity and the one or more mask templates and a relational link between the building entity and the private information. In some embodiments, the method includes retrieving the private information for the building entity in response to the reception of the request for the information is based on the relational link between the building entity and the private information.

(28) In some embodiments, the method includes receiving new entity data, the new entity data including at least one of a new building entity and a new link between the new building entity and at least one of the entities of the set of entities, new private information and a new link between the new private information and at least one of the entities of the set of entities, or new mask templates and a new link between the new mask templates and at least one of the entities of the set of entities, adding the new entity data to the entity database, determining the transitive closure of the entity database based on the set of entities, the set of relational links, and the new entity data added to the entity database, and updating the entity database by updating the set of relational links based on the transitive closure by adding new direct relational links between the entities of the set of entities to the set of relational links.

(29) Another implementation of the present disclosure is an information management system for a building. The information management system includes a building entity database including a building entity, mask templates, and the relational link between the building entity and the mask templates. The system includes a processing circuit configured to receive a request for information for a building entity of the building entity database from a requesting device, select one of the mask templates from the entity database based on access values associated with the requesting device and the relational link between the building entity and the mask templates, wherein the one of the mask templates includes masking operators, one of the masking operators associated with each of attributes of the information. The processing circuit is configured to retrieve the information for the building entity in response to a reception of the request for the information, wherein the information includes the attributes. The processing circuit is configured to generate a masked information data structure based on the retrieved information and the selected one of the mask templates by applying each of the masking operators to the attribute associated with the masking operator and provide the masked information data structure to the requesting device in response to the reception of the request for the information.

- (30) In some embodiments, the processing circuit is configured to select the one of the mask templates by selecting the one of the mask templates as a function of the access values.
- (31) In some embodiments, each of the mask templates is associated with a particular combination of values of the access values. In some embodiments, the processing circuit is configured to select the one of the mask templates by selecting the one of the mask templates based on the particular combination of values of the access values by identifying the one of the mask templates associated with the particular combination of the values of the access values.
- (32) In some embodiments, the masking operators include at least one of a masking operator configured to replace one or more values of a particular attribute of the attributes with a particular masking character, a masking operator configured to show the particular attribute in the clear, a masking operator configured to show only a particular number of values of the attribute, or a masking operator configured to apply a particular encryption method on the particular attribute.
- (33) In some embodiments, the processing circuit is configured to determine a transitive closure for the entity database based on a set of entities of the entity database and a set of relational links between entities of the set of entities, the set of entities including at least the building entity, the mask templates, and the private information and update the entity database based on the transitive closure by adding additional relational links between the entities of the set of entities, the additional relational links including at least one of the relational link between the building entity and the one or more mask templates and a relational link between the building entity and the private information. In some embodiments, the processing circuit is configured to retrieve the private information for the building entity in response to the reception of the request for the information based on the relational link between the building entity and the private information.
- (34) Another implementation of the present disclosure is a database system for a building. The database system includes one or more storage devices configured to implement a building entity database including a set of entities and a set of relational links between entities of the set of entities, wherein the set of entities includes a building entity, private information, and one or more mask templates and a processing circuit. The processing circuit is configured to determine a transitive closure for the entity database based on the set of entities of the entity database and the set of relational links and update the entity database based on the transitive closure by adding additional relational links including at least one of a relational link between the building entity and the one or more mask templates or a relational link between the building entity and the private information. The processing circuit is configured to receive a request for the private information, select one of the mask templates from the entity database based on access values and the relational link between the building entity and the mask templates, retrieve the private information for the building entity based on the relational link between the building entity and the private information in response to a reception of the request for the information, and generate a masked information data structure based on the retrieved information and the selected one of the mask templates.
- (35) In some embodiments, the processing circuit is configured to receive new entity data, the new entity data including at least one of a new building entity and a new link between the new building entity and at least one of the entities of the set of entities, new private information and a new link between the new private information and at least one of the entities of the set of entities, or new mask templates and a new link between the new mask templates and at least one of the entities of the set of entities, add the new entity data to the entity database, determine the transitive closure of the entity database based on the set of entities and the new entity data added to the entity database, and update the entity database by updating the set of relational links based on the transitive closure by adding new direct relational links between the entities of the set of entities to the set of relational links.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) The above and other aspects and features of the present disclosure will become more apparent to those skilled in the art from the following detailed description of the example embodiments with reference to the accompanying drawings.
- (2) FIG. 1 is a block diagram of a smart building environment, according to an exemplary embodiment.

- (3) FIG. 2 is a perspective view of a smart building, according to an exemplary embodiment.
- (4) FIG. 3 is a block diagram of a waterside system, according to an exemplary embodiment.
- (5) FIG. 4 is a block diagram of an airside system, according to an exemplary embodiment.
- (6) FIG. 5 is a block diagram of a building management system, according to an exemplary embodiment.
- (7) FIG. 6 is a block diagram of another building management system including a timeseries service and an entity service, according to an exemplary embodiment.
- (8) FIG. 7 is a block diagram illustrating the entity service of FIG. 6 in greater detail, according to an exemplary embodiment.
- (9) FIG. 8 is an example entity graph of entity data, according to an exemplary embodiment.
- (10) FIG. 9 is a block diagram illustrating the timeseries service of FIG. 6 in greater detail, according to an exemplary embodiment.
- (11) FIG. 10 is an example entity graph of entity data, according to an exemplary embodiment.
- (12) FIG. 11 is a block diagram of the entity service of FIG. 7 performing private information management with mask templates, according to an exemplary embodiment.
- (13) FIG. 12 is a block diagram of a mask retrieval structure for performing the private information management by the entity service of FIG. 11, according to an exemplary embodiment.
- (14) FIG. 13 is a block diagram of a private information data structure and masked response data structure, the masked response data structure generated by the entity service of FIG. 11 based on the private information data structure and a mask template of the mask templates of FIG. 12, according to an exemplary embodiment.
- (15) FIG. 14 is the private information data structure and the masked response data structure of FIG. 13 and masking operators of a mask template of the mask templates of FIG. 12, according to an exemplary embodiment.
- (16) FIG. 15 is a block diagram illustrating selection by the entity service of FIG. 11 retrieving resource information for a principle as a function of multiple access values, according to an exemplary embodiment.
- (17) FIG. 16 is a block diagram of an entity database of the entity service of FIG. 11, the entity database including multiple interrelated entities including the mask templates of FIG. 11 and private information, according to an exemplary embodiment.
- (18) FIG. 17 is a flow diagram of a process for masking private information of a building entity with a mask template that can be performed by the entity service of FIG. 11, according to an exemplary embodiment.
- (19) FIG. 18 is a flow diagram of a process for masking private information of a first building entity and masking private information of a second building entity related to the first building entity by the entity service of FIG. 11, according to an exemplary embodiment.
- (20) FIG. 19A is another block diagram of the entity database of the entity service of FIG. 11 where the entity service of FIG. 11 determines a transitive closure for the entity database, according to an exemplary embodiment.
- (21) FIG. 19B is another block diagram of the entity database of the entity service of FIG. 11 where the entity service of FIG. 11 determines a transitive closure for the entity database to determine inheritance of information for access control systems, according to an exemplary embodiment.
- (22) FIG. 20 is another block diagram of the entity database of the entity service of FIG. 11 where a new object entity is added to the entity database, according to an exemplary embodiment.
- (23) FIG. 21 is another block diagram of the entity database of FIG. 20 where a transitive closure is determined by the entity service of FIG. 11 for the entity database based on the new object entity being added to the entity database, according to an exemplary embodiment.
- (24) FIG. 22 is a flow diagram of a process for adding the new object entity to the entity database of FIGS. 20-21 and determining the transitive closure for the entity database, according to an exemplary embodiment.
- (25) FIG. 23 is another block diagram of the entity database of the entity service of FIG. 11 where new PII is added to the entity database, according to an exemplary embodiment.
- (26) FIG. 24 is another block diagram of the entity database of FIG. 23 where a transitive closure is determined by the entity service of FIG. 11 for the entity database based on the new PII being added to the entity database, according to an exemplary embodiment.

- (27) FIG. 25 is a flow diagram of a process for adding the new PII to the entity database of FIGS. 23-24 and determining the transitive closure for the entity database, according to an exemplary embodiment.
- (28) FIG. 26 is another block diagram of the entity database of the entity service of FIG. 11 where new mask templates are added to the entity database, according to an exemplary embodiment.
- (29) FIG. 27 is another block diagram of the entity database of FIG. 26 where a transitive closure is determined by the entity service of FIG. 11 for the entity database based on the new mask templates being added to the entity database, according to an exemplary embodiment.
- (30) FIG. 28 is a flow diagram of a process for adding the new mask templates to the entity database of FIGS. 26-27 and determining the transitive closure for the entity database, according to an exemplary embodiment.
- (31) FIG. 29 is a block diagram of the cloud entity service of FIG. 22 transporting a mask template to other systems, according to an exemplary embodiment.
- (32) FIG. 30 is a flow diagram of a process for transporting the mask template to the other systems of FIG. 29, according to an exemplary embodiment.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

- (33) Referring generally to the FIGURES, a building system with smart entity personal identifying information (PII) masking is shown, according to various exemplary embodiments. A building system may store an entity database and private information (e.g., PII) for the building entities of the entity database. The entity database may be a database of various entities (e.g., entities that represent people, relationships, classes, BMS Internet of things (IoT) devices, etc.) that are linked to each other. The private information may be information related to the building entities that should be kept private and/or protected. Examples of such information may be an encryption key, a password, a social security number, a username, a data point, a telephone number, an address, an E-mail address, etc.
- (34) The building system as described herein can be configured to store one or multiple mask templates in the entity database. The building entities can each be linked to various mask templates. The mask templates can define that certain access values associated with a requesting client have access to (or do not have access to) certain pieces of private information linked to the building entities. In this regard, the mask templates can be utilized by the building system to implement attribute level protection of private information for the building entities. Specific building entities can be linked to multiple mask templates, each of the mask templates related to a same specific set of access values.
- (35) In this regard, the building system can be configured to receive a request for private information for a specific building entity from the client device. The request can include, or can be associated, with multiple access values. The access values can be a role. The role may define a certain level of access for the client device and/or a role of a user operating the client device (e.g., guest user, an administrator, super user, building technician, building tenant, building employee, supervisor, etc.). The access values can also be an application value, the application value indicating the type of application that the client device is utilizing, e.g., what software the client device is operating or logged into to perform the request. Various other access values (e.g., business use, geographic location, etc.) can be utilized by the building system and are described further elsewhere herein.
- (36) Based on the access values, the building system can select a particular mask template of the multiple mask templates linked to the building entity as a function of the access values received from and/or associated with the client device. The building system can retrieve the selected mask template and the private information associated with the building entity. Based on the selected mask template, the private information can be masked with multiple mask operators of the mask template, each masking operator being linked with one of the attributes of the private information (e.g., one of the data entries of the private information). The resulting masked private information can be provided to the client device.
- (37) Utilizing the mask templates implements an efficient solution to directly masking attribute level information for various circumstances (e.g., various combinations of access values). The mask templates can be entity specific, i.e., a specific entity may have its own set of mask templates. However, the mask templates may also be related to groups of entities (e.g., all thermostat entities may have the same set of mask templates while all user entities may have another set of mask templates). Since there may be a large amount of private information in the entity database, and a large number of different users that may be requesting the private information from different geographic locations, with different applications, and different roles, it is difficult to efficiently identify what attribute level information each user should be able

to view. Some solutions may implement one or more large data structures which tabulate each attribute accessibility for each user. However, this is inefficient and requires large amounts of data storage, processing power, and design time. However, multiple reusable template masks allows for linkage between one or multiple building entities and provides a concise description of the attribute level accessibility of building entity without needing to be user specific, instead, it is access value specific.

(38) The building system that performs PII masking with mask templates as described herein reduces storage requirements, does not require large user specific access tables, and is an easily extensible access system. For example, if a user wishes to adjust the information that can be accessed by a guest user on a specific platform for a particular entity, in this example, via a web browser, the single mask template for the entity that relates to guest user access value and web browser access value can be adjusted. This adjustment is then implemented by the building system for all access requests initiated by a client device that has a guest user role and access the system on a web browser. Adjusting the single mask template is more efficient than adjusting every entry of a user access table that indicates the access abilities of every single user.

(39) Using the masking techniques as described herein, an extensible information management system can be implemented, one where new entities can easily be added and linked to existing mask templates without requiring substantial user interaction. For example, there may be a thermostat entity class. One thermostat of the thermostat entity class can be linked to a set of thermostat mask templates. If another thermostat is added, the mask templates do not need to be recreated and the new thermostat can be linked to the set of mask templates. In some embodiments, the link occurs automatically based on the thermostat, i.e., all thermostat entities of the thermostat class are automatically linked to the same thermostat mask templates.

(40) Hereinafter, example embodiments will be described in more detail with reference to the accompanying drawings. FIG. 1 is a block diagram of a smart building environment **100**, according to some exemplary embodiments. Smart building environment **100** is shown to include a building management platform **102**. Building management platform **102** can be configured to collect data from a variety of different data sources. For example, building management platform **102** is shown collecting data from buildings **110**, **120**, **130**, and **140**. For example, the buildings may include a school **110**, a hospital **120**, a factory **130**, an office building **140**, and/or the like. However the present disclosure is not limited to the number or types of buildings **110**, **120**, **130**, and **140** shown in FIG. 1. For example, in some embodiments, building management platform **102** may be configured to collect data from one or more buildings, and the one or more buildings may be the same type of building, or may include one or more different types of buildings than that shown in FIG. 1.

(41) Building management platform **102** can be configured to collect data from a variety of devices **112-116**, **122-126**, **132-136**, and **142-146**, either directly (e.g., directly via network **104**) or indirectly (e.g., via systems or applications in the buildings **110**, **120**, **130**, **140**). In some embodiments, devices **112-116**, **122-126**, **132-136**, and **142-146** are internet of things (IoT) devices. IoT devices may include any of a variety of physical devices, sensors, actuators, electronics, vehicles, home appliances, and/or other items having network connectivity which enable IoT devices to communicate with building management platform **102**. For example, IoT devices can include smart home hub devices, smart house devices, doorbell cameras, air quality sensors, smart switches, smart lights, smart appliances, garage door openers, smoke detectors, heart monitoring implants, biochip transponders, cameras streaming live feeds, automobiles with built-in sensors, DNA analysis devices, field operation devices, tracking devices for people/vehicles/equipment, networked sensors, wireless sensors, wearable sensors, environmental sensors, RFID gateways and readers, IoT gateway devices, robots and other robotic devices, GPS devices, smart watches, virtual/augmented reality devices, and/or other networked or networkable devices. While the devices described herein are generally referred to as IoT devices, it should be understood that, in various embodiments, the devices referenced in the present disclosure could be any type of devices capable of communicating data over an electronic network.

(42) In some embodiments, IoT devices may include sensors or sensor systems. For example, IoT devices may include acoustic sensors, sound sensors, vibration sensors, automotive or transportation sensors, chemical sensors, electric current sensors, electric voltage sensors, magnetic sensors, radio sensors, environment sensors, weather sensors, moisture sensors, humidity sensors, flow sensors, fluid velocity sensors, ionizing radiation sensors, subatomic particle sensors, navigation instruments, position sensors, angle sensors, displacement sensors, distance sensors, speed sensors, acceleration sensors, optical sensors,

light sensors, imaging devices, photon sensors, pressure sensors, force sensors, density sensors, level sensors, thermal sensors, heat sensors, temperature sensors, proximity sensors, presence sensors, and/or any other type of sensors or sensing systems.

(43) Examples of acoustic, sound, or vibration sensors include geophones, hydrophones, lace sensors, guitar pickups, microphones, and seismometers. Examples of automotive or transportation sensors include air flow meters, air-fuel ratio (AFR) meters, blind spot monitors, crankshaft position sensors, defect detectors, engine coolant temperature sensors, Hall effect sensors, knock sensors, map sensors, mass flow sensors, oxygen sensors, parking sensors, radar guns, speedometers, speed sensors, throttle position sensors, tire-pressure monitoring sensors, torque sensors, transmission fluid temperature sensors, turbine speed sensors, variable reluctance sensors, vehicle speed sensors, water sensors, and wheel speed sensors.

(44) Examples of chemical sensors include breathalyzers, carbon dioxide sensors, carbon monoxide detectors, catalytic bead sensors, chemical field-effect transistors, chemiresistors, electrochemical gas sensors, electronic noses, electrolyte-insulator-semiconductor sensors, fluorescent chloride sensors, holographic sensors, hydrocarbon dew point analyzers, hydrogen sensors, hydrogen sulfide sensors, infrared point sensors, ion-selective electrodes, nondispersive infrared sensors, microwave chemistry sensors, nitrogen oxide sensors, olfactometers, optodes, oxygen sensors, ozone monitors, pellistors, pH glass electrodes, potentiometric sensors, redox electrodes, smoke detectors, and zinc oxide nanorod sensors.

(45) Examples of electromagnetic sensors include current sensors, Daly detectors, electroscopes, electron multipliers, Faraday cups, galvanometers, Hall effect sensors, Hall probes, magnetic anomaly detectors, magnetometers, magnetoresistances, mems magnetic field sensors, metal detectors, planar hall sensors, radio direction finders, and voltage detectors.

(46) Examples of environmental sensors include actinometers, air pollution sensors, bedwetting alarms, ceilometers, dew warnings, electrochemical gas sensors, fish counters, frequency domain sensors, gas detectors, hook gauge evaporimeters, humistors, hygrometers, leaf sensors, lysimeters, pyranometers, pyrgeometers, psychrometers, rain gauges, rain sensors, seismometers, SNOTEL sensors, snow gauges, soil moisture sensors, stream gauges, and tide gauges. Examples of flow and fluid velocity sensors include air flow meters, anemometers, flow sensors, gas meter, mass flow sensors, and water meters.

(47) Examples of radiation and particle sensors include cloud chambers, Geiger counters, Geiger-Muller tubes, ionisation chambers, neutron detections, proportional counters, scintillation counters, semiconductor detectors, and thermoluminescent dosimeters. Examples of navigation instruments include air speed indicators, altimeters, attitude indicators, depth gauges, fluxgate compasses, gyroscopes, inertial navigation systems, inertial reference nits, magnetic compasses, MHD sensors, ring laser gyroscopes, turn coordinators, tialinx sensors, variometers, vibrating structure gyroscopes, and yaw rate sensors.

(48) Examples of position, angle, displacement, distance, speed, and acceleration sensors include auxanometers, capacitive displacement sensors, capacitive sensing devices, flex sensors, free fall sensors, gravimeters, gyroscopic sensors, impact sensors, inclinometers, integrated circuit piezoelectric sensors, laser rangefinders, laser surface velocimeters, Light Detection And Ranging (LIDAR) sensors, linear encoders, linear variable differential transformers (LVDT), liquid capacitive inclinometers odometers, photoelectric sensors, piezoelectric accelerometers, position sensors, position sensitive devices, angular rate sensors, rotary encoders, rotary variable differential transformers, selsyns, shock detectors, shock data loggers, tilt sensors, tachometers, ultrasonic thickness gauges, variable reluctance sensors, and velocity receivers.

(49) Examples of optical, light, imaging, and photon sensors include charge-coupled devices, complementary metal-oxide-semiconductor (CMOS) sensors, colorimeters, contact image sensors, electro-optical sensors, flame detectors, infra-red sensors, kinetic inductance detectors, led as light sensors, light-addressable potentiometric sensors, Nichols radiometers, fiber optic sensors, optical position sensors, thermopile laser sensors, photodetectors, photodiodes, photomultiplier tubes, phototransistors, photoelectric sensors, photoionization detectors, photomultipliers, photoresistors, photoswitches, phototubes, scintillometers, Shack-Hartmann sensors, single-photon avalanche diodes, superconducting nanowire single-photon detectors, transition edge sensors, visible light photon counters, and wavefront sensors.

(50) Examples of pressure sensors include barographs, barometers, boost gauges, bourdon gauges, hot filament ionization gauges, ionization gauges, McLeod gauges, oscillating u-tubes, permanent downhole

gauges, piezometers, pirani gauges, pressure sensors, pressure gauges, tactile sensors, and time pressure gauges. Examples of force, density, and level sensors include bhangmeters, hydrometers, force gauge and force sensors, level sensors, load cells, magnetic level gauges, nuclear density gauges, piezocapacitive pressure sensors, piezoelectric sensors, strain gauges, torque sensors, and viscometers.

(51) Examples of thermal, heat, and temperature sensors include bolometers, bimetallic strips, calorimeters, exhaust gas temperature gauges, flame detections, Gardon gauges, Golay cells, heat flux sensors, infrared thermometers, microbolometers, microwave radiometers, net radiometers, quartz thermometers, resistance thermometers, silicon bandgap temperature sensors, special sensor microwave/imagers, temperature gauges, thermistors, thermocouples, thermometers, and pyrometers. Examples of proximity and presence sensors include alarm sensors, Doppler radars, motion detectors, occupancy sensors, proximity sensors, passive infrared sensors, reed switches, stud finders, triangulation sensors, touch switches, and wired gloves.

(52) In some embodiments, different sensors send measurements or other data to building management platform **102** using a variety of different communications protocols or data formats. Building management platform **102** can be configured to ingest sensor data received in any protocol or data format and translate the inbound sensor data into a common data format. Building management platform **102** can create a sensor object smart entity for each sensor that communicates with Building management platform **102**. Each sensor object smart entity may include one or more static attributes that describe the corresponding sensor, one or more dynamic attributes that indicate the most recent values collected by the sensor, and/or one or more relational attributes that relate sensors object smart entities to each other and/or to other types of smart entities (e.g., space entities, system entities, data entities, etc.).

(53) In some embodiments, building management platform **102** stores sensor data using data entities. Each data entity may correspond to a particular sensor and may include a timeseries of data values received from the corresponding sensor. In some embodiments, building management platform **102** stores relational entities that define relationships between sensor object entities and the corresponding data entity. For example, each relational entity may identify a particular sensor object entity, a particular data entity, and may define a link between such entities.

(54) Building management platform **102** can collect data from a variety of external systems or services. For example, building management platform **102** is shown receiving weather data from a weather service **152**, news data from a news service **154**, documents and other document-related data from a document service **156**, and media (e.g., video, images, audio, social media, etc.) from a media service **158** (hereinafter referred to collectively as 3.sup.rd party services). In some embodiments, building management platform **102** generates data internally. For example, building management platform **102** may include a web advertising system, a website traffic monitoring system, a web sales system, or other types of platform services that generate data.

(55) The data generated by building management platform **102** can be collected, stored, and processed along with the data received from other data sources. Building management platform **102** can collect data directly from external systems or devices or via a network **104** (e.g., a WAN, the Internet, a cellular network, etc.). Building management platform **102** can process and transform collected data to generate timeseries data and entity data. Several features of building management platform **102** are described in more detail below.

(56) Building HVAC Systems and Building Management Systems

(57) Referring now to FIGS. 2-5, several building management systems (BMS) and HVAC systems in which the systems and methods of the present disclosure can be implemented are shown, according to some embodiments. In brief overview, FIG. 2 shows a building **10** equipped with, for example, a HVAC system **200**. Building **10** may be any of the buildings **210**, **220**, **230**, and **140** as shown in FIG. 1, or may be any other suitable building that is communicatively connected to building management platform **102**. FIG. 3 is a block diagram of a waterside system **300** which can be used to serve building **10**. FIG. 4 is a block diagram of an airside system **400** which can be used to serve building **10**. FIG. 5 is a block diagram of a building management system (BMS) which can be used to monitor and control building **10**.

(58) Building and HVAC System

(59) Referring particularly to FIG. 2, a perspective view of a smart building **10** is shown. Building **10** is served by a BMS. A BMS is, in general, a system of devices configured to control, monitor, and manage equipment in or around a building or building area. A BMS can include, for example, a HVAC system, a

security system, a lighting system, a fire alerting system, and any other system that is capable of managing building functions or devices, or any combination thereof. Further, each of the systems may include sensors and other devices (e.g., IoT devices) for the proper operation, maintenance, monitoring, and the like of the respective systems.

(60) The BMS that serves building **10** includes a HVAC system **200**. HVAC system **200** can include HVAC devices (e.g., heaters, chillers, air handling units, pumps, fans, thermal energy storage, etc.) configured to provide heating, cooling, ventilation, or other services for building **10**. For example, HVAC system **200** is shown to include a waterside system **220** and an airside system **230**. Waterside system **220** may provide a heated or chilled fluid to an air handling unit of airside system **230**. Airside system **230** may use the heated or chilled fluid to heat or cool an airflow provided to building **10**. An exemplary waterside system and airside system which can be used in HVAC system **200** are described in greater detail with reference to FIGS. **3** and **4**.

(61) HVAC system **200** is shown to include a chiller **202**, a boiler **204**, and a rooftop air handling unit (AHU) **206**. Waterside system **220** may use boiler **204** and chiller **202** to heat or cool a working fluid (e.g., water, glycol, etc.) and may circulate the working fluid to AHU **206**. In various embodiments, the HVAC devices of waterside system **220** can be located in or around building **10** (as shown in FIG. **2**) or at an offsite location such as a central plant (e.g., a chiller plant, a steam plant, a heat plant, etc.). The working fluid can be heated in boiler **204** or cooled in chiller **202**, depending on whether heating or cooling is required in building **10**. Boiler **204** may add heat to the circulated fluid, for example, by burning a combustible material (e.g., natural gas) or using an electric heating element. Chiller **202** may place the circulated fluid in a heat exchange relationship with another fluid (e.g., a refrigerant) in a heat exchanger (e.g., an evaporator) to absorb heat from the circulated fluid. The working fluid from chiller **202** and/or boiler **204** can be transported to AHU **206** via piping **208**.

(62) AHU **206** may place the working fluid in a heat exchange relationship with an airflow passing through AHU **206** (e.g., via one or more stages of cooling coils and/or heating coils). The airflow can be, for example, outside air, return air from within building **10**, or a combination of both. AHU **206** may transfer heat between the airflow and the working fluid to provide heating or cooling for the airflow. For example, AHU **206** can include one or more fans or blowers configured to pass the airflow over or through a heat exchanger containing the working fluid. The working fluid may then return to chiller **202** or boiler **204** via piping **210**.

(63) Airside system **230** may deliver the airflow supplied by AHU **206** (i.e., the supply airflow) to building **10** via air supply ducts **212** and may provide return air from building **10** to AHU **206** via air return ducts **214**. In some embodiments, airside system **230** includes multiple variable air volume (VAV) units **216**. For example, airside system **230** is shown to include a separate VAV unit **216** on each floor or zone of building **10**. VAV units **216** can include dampers or other flow control elements that can be operated to control an amount of the supply airflow provided to individual zones of building **10**. In other embodiments, airside system **230** delivers the supply airflow into one or more zones of building **10** (e.g., via supply ducts **212**) without using intermediate VAV units **216** or other flow control elements. AHU **206** can include various sensors (e.g., temperature sensors, pressure sensors, etc.) configured to measure attributes of the supply airflow. AHU **206** may receive input from sensors located within AHU **206** and/or within the building zone and may adjust the flow rate, temperature, or other attributes of the supply airflow through AHU **206** to achieve setpoint conditions for the building zone.

(64) Waterside System

(65) Referring now to FIG. **3**, a block diagram of a waterside system **300** is shown, according to some embodiments. In various embodiments, waterside system **300** may supplement or replace waterside system **220** in HVAC system **200** or can be implemented separate from HVAC system **200**. When implemented in HVAC system **200**, waterside system **300** can include a subset of the HVAC devices in HVAC system **200** (e.g., boiler **204**, chiller **202**, pumps, valves, etc.) and may operate to supply a heated or chilled fluid to AHU **206**. The HVAC devices of waterside system **300** can be located within building **10** (e.g., as components of waterside system **220**) or at an offsite location such as a central plant.

(66) In FIG. **3**, waterside system **300** is shown as a central plant having subplants **302-312**. Subplants **302-312** are shown to include a heater subplant **302**, a heat recovery chiller subplant **304**, a chiller subplant **306**, a cooling tower subplant **308**, a hot thermal energy storage (TES) subplant **310**, and a cold thermal energy storage (TES) subplant **312**. Subplants **302-312** consume resources (e.g., water, natural gas,

electricity, etc.) from utilities to serve thermal energy loads (e.g., hot water, cold water, heating, cooling, etc.) of a building or campus. For example, heater subplant **302** can be configured to heat water in a hot water loop **314** that circulates the hot water between heater subplant **302** and building **10**. Chiller subplant **306** can be configured to chill water in a cold water loop **316** that circulates the cold water between chiller subplant **306** and building **10**. Heat recovery chiller subplant **304** can be configured to transfer heat from cold water loop **316** to hot water loop **314** to provide additional heating for the hot water and additional cooling for the cold water. Condenser water loop **318** may absorb heat from the cold water in chiller subplant **306** and reject the absorbed heat in cooling tower subplant **308** or transfer the absorbed heat to hot water loop **314**. Hot TES subplant **310** and cold TES subplant **312** may store hot and cold thermal energy, respectively, for subsequent use.

(67) Hot water loop **314** and cold water loop **316** may deliver the heated and/or chilled water to air handlers located on the rooftop of building **10** (e.g., AHU **206**) or to individual floors or zones of building **10** (e.g., VAV units **216**). The air handlers push air past heat exchangers (e.g., heating coils or cooling coils) through which the water flows to provide heating or cooling for the air. The heated or cooled air can be delivered to individual zones of building **10** to serve thermal energy loads of building **10**. The water then returns to subplants **302-312** to receive further heating or cooling.

(68) Although subplants **302-312** are shown and described as heating and cooling water for circulation to a building, it is understood that any other type of working fluid (e.g., glycol, CO₂, etc.) can be used in place of or in addition to water to serve thermal energy loads. In other embodiments, subplants **302-312** may provide heating and/or cooling directly to the building or campus without requiring an intermediate heat transfer fluid. These and other variations to waterside system **300** are within the teachings of the present disclosure.

(69) Each of subplants **302-312** can include a variety of equipment configured to facilitate the functions of the subplant. For example, heater subplant **302** is shown to include heating elements **320** (e.g., boilers, electric heaters, etc.) configured to add heat to the hot water in hot water loop **314**. Heater subplant **302** is also shown to include several pumps **322** and **324** configured to circulate the hot water in hot water loop **314** and to control the flow rate of the hot water through individual heating elements **320**. Chiller subplant **306** is shown to include chillers **332** configured to remove heat from the cold water in cold water loop **316**. Chiller subplant **306** is also shown to include several pumps **334** and **336** configured to circulate the cold water in cold water loop **316** and to control the flow rate of the cold water through individual chillers **332**.

(70) Heat recovery chiller subplant **304** is shown to include heat recovery heat exchangers **326** (e.g., refrigeration circuits) configured to transfer heat from cold water loop **316** to hot water loop **314**. Heat recovery chiller subplant **304** is also shown to include several pumps **328** and **330** configured to circulate the hot water and/or cold water through heat recovery heat exchangers **326** and to control the flow rate of the water through individual heat recovery heat exchangers **326**. Cooling tower subplant **308** is shown to include cooling towers **338** configured to remove heat from the condenser water in condenser water loop **318**. Cooling tower subplant **308** is also shown to include several pumps **340** configured to circulate the condenser water in condenser water loop **318** and to control the flow rate of the condenser water through individual cooling towers **338**.

(71) Hot TES subplant **310** is shown to include a hot TES tank **342** configured to store the hot water for later use. Hot TES subplant **310** may also include one or more pumps or valves configured to control the flow rate of the hot water into or out of hot TES tank **342**. Cold TES subplant **312** is shown to include cold TES tanks **344** configured to store the cold water for later use. Cold TES subplant **312** may also include one or more pumps or valves configured to control the flow rate of the cold water into or out of cold TES tanks **344**.

(72) In some embodiments, one or more of the pumps in waterside system **300** (e.g., pumps **322**, **324**, **328**, **330**, **334**, **336**, and/or **340**) or pipelines in waterside system **300** include an isolation valve associated therewith. Isolation valves can be integrated with the pumps or positioned upstream or downstream of the pumps to control the fluid flows in waterside system **300**. In various embodiments, waterside system **300** can include more, fewer, or different types of devices and/or subplants based on the particular configuration of waterside system **300** and the types of loads served by waterside system **300**.

(73) Airside System

(74) Referring now to FIG. **4**, a block diagram of an airside system **400** is shown, according to some embodiments. In various embodiments, airside system **400** may supplement or replace airside system **230**

in HVAC system **200** or can be implemented separate from HVAC system **200**. When implemented in HVAC system **200**, airside system **400** can include a subset of the HVAC devices in HVAC system **200** (e.g., AHU **206**, VAV units **216**, ducts **212-214**, fans, dampers, etc.) and can be located in or around building **10**. Airside system **400** may operate to heat or cool an airflow provided to building **10** using a heated or chilled fluid provided by waterside system **300**.

(75) In FIG. **4**, airside system **400** is shown to include an economizer-type air handling unit (AHU) **402**. Economizer-type AHUs vary the amount of outside air and return air used by the air handling unit for heating or cooling. For example, AHU **402** may receive return air **404** from building zone **406** via return air duct **408** and may deliver supply air **410** to building zone **406** via supply air duct **412**. In some embodiments, AHU **402** is a rooftop unit located on the roof of building **10** (e.g., AHU **206** as shown in FIG. **2**) or otherwise positioned to receive both return air **404** and outside air **414**. AHU **402** can be configured to operate exhaust air damper **416**, mixing damper **418**, and outside air damper **420** to control an amount of outside air **414** and return air **404** that combine to form supply air **410**. Any return air **404** that does not pass through mixing damper **418** can be exhausted from AHU **402** through exhaust damper **416** as exhaust air **422**.

(76) Each of dampers **416-420** can be operated by an actuator. For example, exhaust air damper **416** can be operated by actuator **424**, mixing damper **418** can be operated by actuator **426**, and outside air damper **420** can be operated by actuator **428**. Actuators **424-428** may communicate with an AHU controller **430** via a communications link **432**. Actuators **424-428** may receive control signals from AHU controller **430** and may provide feedback signals to AHU controller **430**. Feedback signals can include, for example, an indication of a current actuator or damper position, an amount of torque or force exerted by the actuator, diagnostic information (e.g., results of diagnostic tests performed by actuators **424-428**), status information, commissioning information, configuration settings, calibration data, and/or other types of information or data that can be collected, stored, or used by actuators **424-428**. AHU controller **430** can be an economizer controller configured to use one or more control algorithms (e.g., state-based algorithms, extremum seeking control (ESC) algorithms, proportional-integral (PI) control algorithms, proportional-integral-derivative (PID) control algorithms, model predictive control (MPC) algorithms, feedback control algorithms, etc.) to control actuators **424-428**.

(77) Still referring to FIG. **4**, AHU **304** is shown to include a cooling coil **434**, a heating coil **436**, and a fan **438** positioned within supply air duct **412**. Fan **438** can be configured to force supply air **410** through cooling coil **434** and/or heating coil **436** and provide supply air **410** to building zone **406**. AHU controller **430** may communicate with fan **438** via communications link **440** to control a flow rate of supply air **410**. In some embodiments, AHU controller **430** controls an amount of heating or cooling applied to supply air **410** by modulating a speed of fan **438**.

(78) Cooling coil **434** may receive a chilled fluid from waterside system **300** (e.g., from cold water loop **316**) via piping **442** and may return the chilled fluid to waterside system **300** via piping **444**. Valve **446** can be positioned along piping **442** or piping **444** to control a flow rate of the chilled fluid through cooling coil **434**. In some embodiments, cooling coil **434** includes multiple stages of cooling coils that can be independently activated and deactivated (e.g., by AHU controller **430**, by BMS controller **466**, etc.) to modulate an amount of cooling applied to supply air **410**.

(79) Heating coil **436** may receive a heated fluid from waterside system **300** (e.g., from hot water loop **314**) via piping **448** and may return the heated fluid to waterside system **300** via piping **450**. Valve **452** can be positioned along piping **448** or piping **450** to control a flow rate of the heated fluid through heating coil **436**. In some embodiments, heating coil **436** includes multiple stages of heating coils that can be independently activated and deactivated (e.g., by AHU controller **430**, by BMS controller **466**, etc.) to modulate an amount of heating applied to supply air **410**.

(80) Each of valves **446** and **452** can be controlled by an actuator. For example, valve **446** can be controlled by actuator **454** and valve **452** can be controlled by actuator **456**. Actuators **454-456** may communicate with AHU controller **430** via communications links **458-460**. Actuators **454-456** may receive control signals from AHU controller **430** and may provide feedback signals to controller **430**. In some embodiments, AHU controller **430** receives a measurement of the supply air temperature from a temperature sensor **462** positioned in supply air duct **412** (e.g., downstream of cooling coil **434** and/or heating coil **436**). AHU controller **430** may also receive a measurement of the temperature of building zone **406** from a temperature sensor **464** located in building zone **406**.

(81) In some embodiments, AHU controller **430** operates valves **446** and **452** via actuators **454-456** to modulate an amount of heating or cooling provided to supply air **410** (e.g., to achieve a setpoint temperature for supply air **410** or to maintain the temperature of supply air **410** within a setpoint temperature range). The positions of valves **446** and **452** affect the amount of heating or cooling provided to supply air **410** by cooling coil **434** or heating coil **436** and may correlate with the amount of energy consumed to achieve a desired supply air temperature. AHU controller **430** may control the temperature of supply air **410** and/or building zone **406** by activating or deactivating coils **434-436**, adjusting a speed of fan **438**, or a combination of both.

(82) Still referring to FIG. **4**, airside system **400** is shown to include a building management system (BMS) controller **466** and a client device **468**. BMS controller **466** can include one or more computer systems (e.g., servers, supervisory controllers, subsystem controllers, etc.) that serve as system level controllers, application or data servers, head nodes, or master controllers for airside system **400**, waterside system **300**, HVAC system **200**, and/or other controllable systems that serve building **10**. BMS controller **466** may communicate with multiple downstream building systems or subsystems (e.g., HVAC system **200**, a security system, a lighting system, waterside system **300**, etc.) via a communications link **470** according to like or disparate protocols (e.g., LON, BACnet, etc.). In various embodiments, AHU controller **430** and BMS controller **466** can be separate (as shown in FIG. **4**) or integrated. In an integrated implementation, AHU controller **430** can be a software module configured for execution by a processor of BMS controller **466**.

(83) In some embodiments, AHU controller **430** receives information from BMS controller **466** (e.g., commands, setpoints, operating boundaries, etc.) and provides information to BMS controller **466** (e.g., temperature measurements, valve or actuator positions, operating statuses, diagnostics, etc.). For example, AHU controller **430** may provide BMS controller **466** with temperature measurements from temperature sensors **462-464**, equipment on/off states, equipment operating capacities, and/or any other information that can be used by BMS controller **466** to monitor or control a variable state or condition within building zone **406**.

(84) Client device **468** can include one or more human-machine interfaces or client interfaces (e.g., graphical user interfaces, reporting interfaces, text-based computer interfaces, client-facing web services, web servers that provide pages to web clients, etc.) for controlling, viewing, or otherwise interacting with HVAC system **200**, its subsystems, and/or devices. Client device **468** can be a computer workstation, a client terminal, a remote or local interface, or any other type of user interface device. Client device **468** can be a stationary terminal or a mobile device. For example, client device **468** can be a desktop computer, a computer server with a user interface, a laptop computer, a tablet, a smartphone, a PDA, or any other type of mobile or non-mobile device. Client device **468** may communicate with BMS controller **466** and/or AHU controller **430** via communications link **472**.

(85) Building Management System

(86) Referring now to FIG. **5**, a block diagram of a building management system (BMS) **500** is shown, according to some embodiments. BMS **500** can be implemented in building **10** to automatically monitor and control various building functions. BMS **500** is shown to include BMS controller **466** and building subsystems **528**. Building subsystems **528** are shown to include a building electrical subsystem **534**, an information communication technology (ICT) subsystem **536**, a security subsystem **538**, a HVAC subsystem **540**, a lighting subsystem **542**, a lift/escalators subsystem **532**, and a fire safety subsystem **530**. In various embodiments, building subsystems **528** can include fewer, additional, or alternative subsystems. For example, building subsystems **528** may also or alternatively include a refrigeration subsystem, an advertising or signage subsystem, a cooking subsystem, a vending subsystem, a printer or copy service subsystem, or any other type of building subsystem that uses controllable equipment and/or sensors to monitor or control building **10**. In some embodiments, building subsystems **528** include waterside system **300** and/or airside system **400**, as described with reference to FIGS. **3-4**.

(87) Each of building subsystems **528** can include any number of devices (e.g., IoT devices), sensors, controllers, and connections for completing its individual functions and control activities. HVAC subsystem **540** can include many of the same components as HVAC system **200**, as described with reference to FIGS. **2-4**. For example, HVAC subsystem **540** can include a chiller, a boiler, any number of air handling units, economizers, field controllers, supervisory controllers, actuators, temperature sensors, and other devices for controlling the temperature, humidity, airflow, or other variable conditions within

building **10**. Lighting subsystem **542** can include any number of light fixtures, ballasts, lighting sensors, dimmers, or other devices configured to controllably adjust the amount of light provided to a building space. Security subsystem **538** can include occupancy sensors, video surveillance cameras, digital video recorders, video processing servers, intrusion detection devices, access control devices and servers, or other security-related devices.

(88) Still referring to FIG. 5, BMS controller **466** is shown to include a communications interface **507** and a BMS interface **509**. Interface **507** may facilitate communications between BMS controller **466** and external applications (e.g., monitoring and reporting applications **522**, enterprise control applications **526**, remote systems and applications **544**, applications residing on client devices **548**, 3.sup.rd party services **550**, etc.) for allowing user control, monitoring, and adjustment to BMS controller **466** and/or subsystems **528**. Interface **507** may also facilitate communications between BMS controller **466** and client devices **548**. BMS interface **509** may facilitate communications between BMS controller **466** and building subsystems **528** (e.g., HVAC, lighting security, lifts, power distribution, business, etc.).

(89) Interfaces **507**, **509** can be or include wired or wireless communications interfaces (e.g., jacks, antennas, transmitters, receivers, transceivers, wire terminals, etc.) for conducting data communications with building subsystems **528** or other external systems or devices. In various embodiments, communications via interfaces **507**, **509** can be direct (e.g., local wired or wireless communications) or via a communications network **546** (e.g., a WAN, the Internet, a cellular network, etc.). For example, interfaces **507**, **509** can include an Ethernet card and port for sending and receiving data via an Ethernet-based communications link or network. In another example, interfaces **507**, **509** can include a Wi-Fi transceiver for communicating via a wireless communications network. In another example, one or both of interfaces **507**, **509** can include cellular or mobile phone communications transceivers. In one embodiment, communications interface **507** is a power line communications interface and BMS interface **509** is an Ethernet interface. In other embodiments, both communications interface **507** and BMS interface **509** are Ethernet interfaces or are the same Ethernet interface.

(90) Still referring to FIG. 5, BMS controller **466** is shown to include a processing circuit **504** including a processor **506** and memory **508**. Processing circuit **504** can be communicably connected to BMS interface **509** and/or communications interface **507** such that processing circuit **504** and the various components thereof can send and receive data via interfaces **507**, **509**. Processor **506** can be implemented as a general purpose processor, an application specific integrated circuit (ASIC), one or more field programmable gate arrays (FPGAs), a group of processing components, or other suitable electronic processing components.

(91) Memory **508** (e.g., memory, memory unit, storage device, etc.) can include one or more devices (e.g., RAM, ROM, Flash memory, hard disk storage, etc.) for storing data and/or computer code for completing or facilitating the various processes, layers and modules described in the present application. Memory **508** can be or include volatile memory or non-volatile memory. Memory **508** can include database components, object code components, script components, or any other type of information structure for supporting the various activities and information structures described in the present application. According to some embodiments, memory **508** is communicably connected to processor **506** via processing circuit **504** and includes computer code for executing (e.g., by processing circuit **504** and/or processor **506**) one or more processes described herein.

(92) In some embodiments, BMS controller **466** is implemented within a single computer (e.g., one server, one housing, etc.). In various other embodiments BMS controller **466** can be distributed across multiple servers or computers (e.g., that can exist in distributed locations). Further, while FIG. 4 shows applications **522** and **526** as existing outside of BMS controller **466**, in some embodiments, applications **522** and **526** can be hosted within BMS controller **466** (e.g., within memory **508**).

(93) Still referring to FIG. 5, memory **508** is shown to include an enterprise integration layer **510**, an automated measurement and validation (AM&V) layer **512**, a demand response (DR) layer **514**, a fault detection and diagnostics (FDD) layer **516**, an integrated control layer **518**, and a building subsystem integration later **520**. Layers **510-520** can be configured to receive inputs from building subsystems **528** and other data sources, determine improved and/or optimal control actions for building subsystems **528** based on the inputs, generate control signals based on the improved and/or optimal control actions, and provide the generated control signals to building subsystems **528**. The following paragraphs describe some of the general functions performed by each of layers **510-520** in BMS **500**.

(94) Enterprise integration layer **510** can be configured to serve clients or local applications with

information and services to support a variety of enterprise-level applications. For example, enterprise control applications **526** can be configured to provide subsystem-spanning control to a graphical user interface (GUI) or to any number of enterprise-level business applications (e.g., accounting systems, user identification systems, etc.). Enterprise control applications **526** may also or alternatively be configured to provide configuration GUIs for configuring BMS controller **466**. In yet other embodiments, enterprise control applications **526** can work with layers **510-520** to improve and/or optimize building performance (e.g., efficiency, energy use, comfort, or safety) based on inputs received at interface **507** and/or BMS interface **509**.

(95) Building subsystem integration layer **520** can be configured to manage communications between BMS controller **466** and building subsystems **528**. For example, building subsystem integration layer **520** may receive sensor data and input signals from building subsystems **528** and provide output data and control signals to building subsystems **528**. Building subsystem integration layer **520** may also be configured to manage communications between building subsystems **528**. Building subsystem integration layer **520** translates communications (e.g., sensor data, input signals, output signals, etc.) across multi-vendor/multi-protocol systems.

(96) Demand response layer **514** can be configured to determine (e.g., optimize) resource usage (e.g., electricity use, natural gas use, water use, etc.) and/or the monetary cost of such resource usage to satisfy the demand of building **10**. The resource usage determination can be based on time-of-use prices, curtailment signals, energy availability, or other data received from utility providers, distributed energy generation systems **524**, energy storage **527** (e.g., hot TES **342**, cold TES **344**, etc.), or from other sources. Demand response layer **514** may receive inputs from other layers of BMS controller **466** (e.g., building subsystem integration layer **520**, integrated control layer **518**, etc.). The inputs received from other layers can include environmental or sensor inputs such as temperature, carbon dioxide levels, relative humidity levels, air quality sensor outputs, occupancy sensor outputs, room schedules, and the like. The inputs may also include inputs such as electrical use (e.g., expressed in kWh), thermal load measurements, pricing information, projected pricing, smoothed pricing, curtailment signals from utilities, and the like.

(97) According to some embodiments, demand response layer **514** includes control logic for responding to the data and signals it receives. These responses can include communicating with the control algorithms in integrated control layer **518**, changing control strategies, changing setpoints, or activating/deactivating building equipment or subsystems in a controlled manner. Demand response layer **514** may also include control logic configured to determine when to utilize stored energy. For example, demand response layer **514** may determine to begin using energy from energy storage **527** just prior to the beginning of a peak use hour.

(98) In some embodiments, demand response layer **514** includes a control module configured to actively initiate control actions (e.g., automatically changing setpoints) which reduce (e.g., minimize) energy costs based on one or more inputs representative of or based on demand (e.g., price, a curtailment signal, a demand level, etc.). In some embodiments, demand response layer **514** uses equipment models to determine a improved and/or optimal set of control actions. The equipment models can include, for example, thermodynamic models describing the inputs, outputs, and/or functions performed by various sets of building equipment. Equipment models may represent collections of building equipment (e.g., subplants, chiller arrays, etc.) or individual devices (e.g., individual chillers, heaters, pumps, etc.).

(99) Demand response layer **514** may further include or draw upon one or more demand response policy definitions (e.g., databases, XML files, etc.). The policy definitions can be edited or adjusted by a user (e.g., via a graphical user interface) so that the control actions initiated in response to demand inputs can be tailored for the user's application, desired comfort level, particular building equipment, or based on other concerns. For example, the demand response policy definitions can specify which equipment can be turned on or off in response to particular demand inputs, how long a system or piece of equipment should be turned off, what setpoints can be changed, what the allowable set point adjustment range is, how long to hold a high demand setpoint before returning to a normally scheduled setpoint, how close to approach capacity limits, which equipment modes to utilize, the energy transfer rates (e.g., the maximum rate, an alarm rate, other rate boundary information, etc.) into and out of energy storage devices (e.g., thermal storage tanks, battery banks, etc.), and when to dispatch on-site generation of energy (e.g., via fuel cells, a motor generator set, etc.).

(100) Integrated control layer **518** can be configured to use the data input or output of building subsystem

integration layer **520** and/or demand response layer **514** to make control decisions. Due to the subsystem integration provided by building subsystem integration layer **520**, integrated control layer **518** can integrate control activities of the subsystems **528** such that the subsystems **528** behave as a single integrated super system. In some embodiments, integrated control layer **518** includes control logic that uses inputs and outputs from building subsystems to provide greater comfort and energy savings relative to the comfort and energy savings that separate subsystems could provide alone. For example, integrated control layer **518** can be configured to use an input from a first subsystem to make an energy-saving control decision for a second subsystem. Results of these decisions can be communicated back to building subsystem integration layer **520**.

(101) Integrated control layer **518** is shown to be logically below demand response layer **514**. Integrated control layer **518** can be configured to enhance the effectiveness of demand response layer **514** by enabling building subsystems **528** and their respective control loops to be controlled in coordination with demand response layer **514**. This configuration may advantageously reduce disruptive demand response behavior relative to conventional systems. For example, integrated control layer **518** can be configured to assure that a demand response-driven upward adjustment to the setpoint for chilled water temperature (or another component that directly or indirectly affects temperature) does not result in an increase in fan energy (or other energy used to cool a space) that would result in greater total building energy use than was saved at the chiller.

(102) Integrated control layer **518** can be configured to provide feedback to demand response layer **514** so that demand response layer **514** checks that constraints (e.g., temperature, lighting levels, etc.) are properly maintained even while demanded load shedding is in progress. The constraints may also include setpoint or sensed boundaries relating to safety, equipment operating limits and performance, comfort, fire codes, electrical codes, energy codes, and the like. Integrated control layer **518** is also logically below fault detection and diagnostics layer **516** and automated measurement and validation layer **512**. Integrated control layer **518** can be configured to provide calculated inputs (e.g., aggregations) to these higher levels based on outputs from more than one building subsystem.

(103) Automated measurement and validation (AM&V) layer **512** can be configured to verify that control strategies commanded by integrated control layer **518** or demand response layer **514** are working properly (e.g., using data aggregated by AM&V layer **512**, integrated control layer **518**, building subsystem integration layer **520**, FDD layer **516**, or otherwise). The calculations made by AM&V layer **512** can be based on building system energy models and/or equipment models for individual BMS devices or subsystems. For example, AM&V layer **512** may compare a model-predicted output with an actual output from building subsystems **528** to determine an accuracy of the model.

(104) Fault detection and diagnostics (FDD) layer **516** can be configured to provide on-going fault detection for building subsystems **528**, building subsystem devices (i.e., building equipment), and control algorithms used by demand response layer **514** and integrated control layer **518**. FDD layer **516** may receive data inputs from integrated control layer **518**, directly from one or more building subsystems or devices, or from another data source. FDD layer **516** may automatically diagnose and respond to detected faults. The responses to detected or diagnosed faults can include providing an alert message to a user, a maintenance scheduling system, or a control algorithm configured to attempt to repair the fault or to work-around the fault.

(105) FDD layer **516** can be configured to output a specific identification of the faulty component or cause of the fault (e.g., loose damper linkage) using detailed subsystem inputs available at building subsystem integration layer **520**. In other exemplary embodiments, FDD layer **516** is configured to provide “fault” events to integrated control layer **518** which executes control strategies and policies in response to the received fault events. According to some embodiments, FDD layer **516** (or a policy executed by an integrated control engine or business rules engine) may shut-down systems or direct control activities around faulty devices or systems to reduce energy waste, extend equipment life, or assure proper control response.

(106) FDD layer **516** can be configured to store or access a variety of different system data stores (or data points for live data). FDD layer **516** may use some content of the data stores to identify faults at the equipment level (e.g., specific chiller, specific AHU, specific terminal unit, etc.) and other content to identify faults at component or subsystem levels. For example, building subsystems **528** may generate temporal (i.e., time-series) data indicating the performance of BMS **500** and the various components

thereof. The data generated by building subsystems **528** can include measured or calculated values that exhibit statistical characteristics and provide information about how the corresponding system or process (e.g., a temperature control process, a flow control process, etc.) is performing in terms of error from its setpoint. These processes can be examined by FDD layer **516** to expose when the system begins to degrade in performance and alert a user to repair the fault before it becomes more severe.

(107) Building Management System with Cloud Building Management Platform

(108) Referring now to FIG. **6**, a block diagram of another building management system (BMS) **600** is shown, according to some embodiments. BMS **600** can be configured to collect data samples from client devices **548**, remote systems and applications **544**, 3.sup.rd party services **550**, and/or building subsystems **528**, and provide the data samples to Cloud building management platform **620** to generate raw timeseries data, derived timeseries data, and/or entity data from the data samples. In some embodiments, Cloud building management platform **620** may supplement or replace building management platform **102** shown in FIG. **1** or can be implemented separate from building management platform **102**. Cloud building management platform **620** can process and transform the data samples to generate derived timeseries data. Throughout this disclosure, the term “derived timeseries data” is used to describe the result or output of a transformation or other timeseries processing operation performed by various services of the building management platform **620** (e.g., data aggregation, data cleansing, virtual point calculation, etc.). The term “entity data” is used to describe the attributes of various smart entities (e.g., IoT systems, devices, components, sensors, and the like) and the relationships between the smart entities. The derived timeseries data can be provided to various applications **630** and/or stored in storage **614** (e.g., as materialized views of the raw timeseries data). In some embodiments, Cloud building management platform **620** separates data collection; data storage, retrieval, and analysis; and data visualization into three different layers. This allows Cloud building management platform **620** to support a variety of applications **630** that use the derived timeseries data and allows new applications **630** to reuse the existing infrastructure provided by Cloud building management platform **620**.

(109) It should be noted that the components of BMS **600** and/or Cloud building management platform **620** can be integrated within a single device (e.g., a supervisory controller, a BMS controller, etc.) or distributed across multiple separate systems or devices. In other embodiments, some or all of the components of BMS **600** and/or Cloud building management platform **620** can be implemented as part of a cloud-based computing system configured to receive and process data from one or more building management systems. In other embodiments, some or all of the components of BMS **600** and/or Cloud building management platform **620** can be components of a subsystem level controller (e.g., a HVAC controller), a subplant controller, a device controller (e.g., AHU controller **330**, a chiller controller, etc.), a field controller, a computer workstation, a client device, or any other system or device that receives and processes data from building systems and equipment.

(110) BMS **600** (or cloud building management platform **620**) can include many of the same components as BMS **500** (e.g., processing circuit **504**, processor **506**, and/or memory **508**), as described with reference to FIG. **5**. For example, BMS **600** is shown to include a communications interface **602** (including the BMS interface **509** and the communications interface **507** from FIG. **5**). Interface **602** can include wired or wireless communications interfaces (e.g., jacks, antennas, transmitters, receivers, transceivers, wire terminals, etc.) for conducting data communications with client devices **548**, remote systems and applications **544**, 3.sup.rd party services **550**, building subsystems **528** or other external systems or devices. Communications conducted via interface **602** can be direct (e.g., local wired or wireless communications) or via a communications network **546** (e.g., a WAN, the Internet, a cellular network, etc.).

(111) Communications interface **602** can facilitate communications between BMS **600**, Cloud building management platform services **620**, building subsystems **528**, client devices **548** and external applications (e.g., remote systems and applications **544** and 3.sup.rd party services **550**) for allowing user control, monitoring, and adjustment to BMS **600**. BMS **600** can be configured to communicate with building subsystems **528** using any of a variety of building automation systems protocols (e.g., BACnet, Modbus, ADX, etc.). In some embodiments, BMS **600** receives data samples from building subsystems **528** and provides control signals to building subsystems **528** via interface **602**. In some embodiments, BMS **600** receives data samples from the 3.sup.rd party services **550**, such as, for example, weather data from a weather service, news data from a news service, documents and other document-related data from a

document service, media (e.g., video, images, audio, social media, etc.) from a media service, and/or the like, via interface **602** (e.g., via APIs or any suitable interface).

(112) Building subsystems **528** can include building electrical subsystem **534**, information communication technology (ICT) subsystem **536**, security subsystem **538**, HVAC subsystem **540**, lighting subsystem **542**, lift/escalators subsystem **532**, and/or fire safety subsystem **530**, as described with reference to FIG. 5. In various embodiments, building subsystems **528** can include fewer, additional, or alternative subsystems. For example, building subsystems **528** can also or alternatively include a refrigeration subsystem, an advertising or signage subsystem, a cooking subsystem, a vending subsystem, a printer or copy service subsystem, or any other type of building subsystem that uses controllable equipment and/or sensors to monitor or control building **10**. In some embodiments, building subsystems **528** include waterside system **300** and/or airside system **400**, as described with reference to FIGS. 3-4. Each of building subsystems **528** can include any number of devices, controllers, and connections for completing its individual functions and control activities. Building subsystems **528** can include building equipment (e.g., sensors, air handling units, chillers, pumps, valves, etc.) configured to monitor and control a building condition such as temperature, humidity, airflow, etc.

(113) Still referring to FIG. 6, BMS **600** is shown to include a processing circuit **606** including a processor **608** and memory **610**. Cloud building management platform **620** may include one or more processing circuits including one or more processors and memory. Each of the processor can be a general purpose or specific purpose processor, an application specific integrated circuit (ASIC), one or more field programmable gate arrays (FPGAs), a group of processing components, or other suitable processing components. Each of the processors is configured to execute computer code or instructions stored in memory or received from other computer readable media (e.g., CDROM, network storage, a remote server, etc.).

(114) Memory can include one or more devices (e.g., memory units, memory devices, storage devices, etc.) for storing data and/or computer code for completing and/or facilitating the various processes described in the present disclosure. Memory can include random access memory (RAM), read-only memory (ROM), hard drive storage, temporary storage, non-volatile memory, flash memory, optical memory, or any other suitable memory for storing software objects and/or computer instructions. Memory can include database components, object code components, script components, or any other type of information structure for supporting the various activities and information structures described in the present disclosure. Memory can be communicably connected to the processors via the processing circuits and can include computer code for executing (e.g., by processor **508**) one or more processes described herein.

(115) Still referring to FIG. 6, Cloud building management platform **620** is shown to include a data collector **612**. Data collector **612** is shown receiving data samples from 3.sup.rd party services **550** and building subsystems **528** via interface **602**. However, the present disclosure is not limited thereto, and the data collector **612** may receive the data samples directly from the 3.sup.rd party service **550** or the building subsystems **528** (e.g., via network **546** or via any suitable method). In some embodiments, the data samples include data values for various data points. The data values can be measured and/or calculated values, depending on the type of data point. For example, a data point received from a temperature sensor can include a measured data value indicating a temperature measured by the temperature sensor. A data point received from a chiller controller can include a calculated data value indicating a calculated efficiency of the chiller. A data sample received from a 3.sup.rd party weather service can include both a measured data value (e.g., current temperature) and a calculated data value (e.g., forecast temperature). Data collector **612** can receive data samples from multiple different devices (e.g., IoT devices, sensors, etc.) within building subsystems **528**, and from multiple different 3.sup.rd party services (e.g., weather data from a weather service, news data from a news service, etc.) of the 3.sup.rd party services **550**.

(116) The data samples can include one or more attributes that describe or characterize the corresponding data points. For example, the data samples can include a name attribute defining a point name or ID (e.g., "B1F4R2.T-Z"), a device attribute indicating a type of device from which the data samples is received (e.g., temperature sensor, humidity sensor, chiller, etc.), a unit attribute defining a unit of measure associated with the data value (e.g., ° F., ° C., kPA, etc.), and/or any other attribute that describes the corresponding data point or provides contextual information regarding the data point. The types of attributes included in each data point can depend on the communications protocol used to send the data

samples to BMS **600** and/or Cloud building management platform **620**. For example, data samples received via the ADX protocol or BACnet protocol can include a variety of descriptive attributes along with the data value, whereas data samples received via the Modbus protocol may include a lesser number of attributes (e.g., only the data value without any corresponding attributes).

(117) In some embodiments, each data sample is received with a timestamp indicating a time at which the corresponding data value was measured or calculated. In other embodiments, data collector **612** adds timestamps to the data samples based on the times at which the data samples are received. Data collector **612** can generate raw timeseries data for each of the data points for which data samples are received. Each timeseries can include a series of data values for the same data point and a timestamp for each of the data values. For example, a timeseries for a data point provided by a temperature sensor can include a series of temperature values measured by the temperature sensor and the corresponding times at which the temperature values were measured. An example of a timeseries which can be generated by data collector **612** is as follows: [<key, timestamp.sub.1, value.sub.1>, <key, timestamp.sub.2, value.sub.2>, <key, timestamp.sub.3, value.sub.3>]

where key is an identifier of the source of the raw data samples (e.g., timeseries ID, sensor ID, device ID, etc.), timestamp.sub.i identifies the time at which the ith sample was collected, and value.sub.i indicates the value of the ith sample.

(118) Data collector **612** can add timestamps to the data samples or modify existing timestamps such that each data sample includes a local timestamp. Each local timestamp indicates the local time at which the corresponding data sample was measured or collected and can include an offset relative to universal time. The local timestamp indicates the local time at the location the data point was measured at the time of measurement. The offset indicates the difference between the local time and a universal time (e.g., the time at the international date line). For example, a data sample collected in a time zone that is six hours behind universal time can include a local timestamp (e.g., Timestamp=2016-03-18T14:10:02) and an offset indicating that the local timestamp is six hours behind universal time (e.g., Offset=-6:00). The offset can be adjusted (e.g., +1:00 or -1:00) depending on whether the time zone is in daylight savings time when the data sample is measured or collected.

(119) The combination of the local timestamp and the offset provides a unique timestamp across daylight saving time boundaries. This allows an application using the timeseries data to display the timeseries data in local time without first converting from universal time. The combination of the local timestamp and the offset also provides enough information to convert the local timestamp to universal time without needing to look up a schedule of when daylight savings time occurs. For example, the offset can be subtracted from the local timestamp to generate a universal time value that corresponds to the local timestamp without referencing an external database and without requiring any other information.

(120) In some embodiments, data collector **612** organizes the raw timeseries data. Data collector **612** can identify a system or device associated with each of the data points. For example, data collector **612** can associate a data point with a temperature sensor, an air handler, a chiller, or any other type of system or device. In some embodiments, a data entity may be created for the data point, in which case, the data collector **612** (e.g., via entity service) can associate the data point with the data entity. In various embodiments, data collector uses the name of the data point, a range of values of the data point, statistical characteristics of the data point, or other attributes of the data point to identify a particular system or device associated with the data point. Data collector **612** can then determine how that system or device relates to the other systems or devices in the building site from entity data. For example, data collector **612** can determine that the identified system or device is part of a larger system (e.g., a HVAC system) or serves a particular space (e.g., a particular building, a room or zone of the building, etc.) from the entity data. In some embodiments, data collector **612** uses or retrieves an entity graph (e.g., via entity service **626**) when organizing the timeseries data.

(121) Data collector **612** can provide the raw timeseries data to the services of Cloud building management platform **620** and/or store the raw timeseries data in storage **614**. Storage **614** may be internal storage or external storage. For example, storage **614** can be internal storage with relation to Cloud building management platform **620** and/or BMS **600**, and/or may include a remote database, cloud-based data hosting, or other remote data storage. Storage **614** can be configured to store the raw timeseries data obtained by data collector **612**, the derived timeseries data generated by Cloud building management platform **620**, and/or directed acyclic graphs (DAGs) used by Cloud building management platform **620** to

process the timeseries data.

(122) Still referring to FIG. 5, Cloud building management platform **620** can receive the raw timeseries data from data collector **612** and/or retrieve the raw timeseries data from storage **614**. Cloud building management platform **620** can include a variety of services configured to analyze, process, and transform the raw timeseries data. For example, Cloud building management platform **620** is shown to include a security service **622**, an analytics service **624**, an entity service **626**, and a timeseries service **628**. Security service **622** can assign security attributes to the raw timeseries data to ensure that the timeseries data are only accessible to authorized individuals, systems, or applications. Security service **622** may include a messaging layer to exchange secure messages with the entity service **626**. In some embodiment, security service **622** may provide permission data to entity service **626** so that entity service **626** can determine the types of entity data that can be accessed by a particular entity or device. Entity service **626** can assign entity information (or entity data) to the timeseries data to associate data points with a particular system, device, or space. Timeseries service **628** and analytics service **624** can apply various transformations, operations, or other functions to the raw timeseries data to generate derived timeseries data.

(123) In some embodiments, timeseries service **628** aggregates predefined intervals of the raw timeseries data (e.g., quarter-hourly intervals, hourly intervals, daily intervals, monthly intervals, etc.) to generate new derived timeseries of the aggregated values. These derived timeseries can be referred to as “data rollups” since they are condensed versions of the raw timeseries data. The data rollups generated by timeseries service **628** provide an efficient mechanism for applications **630** to query the timeseries data. For example, applications **630** can construct visualizations of the timeseries data (e.g., charts, graphs, etc.) using the pre-aggregated data rollups instead of the raw timeseries data. This allows applications **630** to simply retrieve and present the pre-aggregated data rollups without requiring applications **630** to perform an aggregation in response to the query. Since the data rollups are pre-aggregated, applications **630** can present the data rollups quickly and efficiently without requiring additional processing at query time to generate aggregated timeseries values.

(124) In some embodiments, timeseries service **628** calculates virtual points based on the raw timeseries data and/or the derived timeseries data. Virtual points can be calculated by applying any of a variety of mathematical operations (e.g., addition, subtraction, multiplication, division, etc.) or functions (e.g., average value, maximum value, minimum value, thermodynamic functions, linear functions, nonlinear functions, etc.) to the actual data points represented by the timeseries data. For example, timeseries service **628** can calculate a virtual data point (pointID.sub.3) by adding two or more actual data points (pointID.sub.1 and pointID.sub.2) (e.g., pointID.sub.3=pointID.sub.1+pointID.sub.2). As another example, timeseries service **628** can calculate an enthalpy data point (pointID.sub.4) based on a measured temperature data point (pointID.sub.5) and a measured pressure data point (pointID.sub.6) (e.g., pointID.sub.4=enthalpy(pointID.sub.5, pointID.sub.6)). The virtual data points can be stored as derived timeseries data.

(125) Applications **630** can access and use the virtual data points in the same manner as the actual data points. Applications **630** may not need to know whether a data point is an actual data point or a virtual data point since both types of data points can be stored as derived timeseries data and can be handled in the same manner by applications **630**. In some embodiments, the derived timeseries are stored with attributes designating each data point as either a virtual data point or an actual data point. Such attributes allow applications **630** to identify whether a given timeseries represents a virtual data point or an actual data point, even though both types of data points can be handled in the same manner by applications **630**. These and other features of timeseries service **628** are described in greater detail with reference to FIG. 9.

(126) In some embodiments, analytics service **624** analyzes the raw timeseries data and/or the derived timeseries data to detect faults. Analytics service **624** can apply a set of fault detection rules to the timeseries data to determine whether a fault is detected at each interval of the timeseries. Fault detections can be stored as derived timeseries data. For example, analytics service **624** can generate a new fault detection timeseries with data values that indicate whether a fault was detected at each interval of the timeseries. The fault detection timeseries can be stored as derived timeseries data along with the raw timeseries data in storage **614**.

(127) In some embodiments, analytics service **624** analyzes the raw timeseries data and/or the derived timeseries data with the entity data to generate alerts or warnings, analyze risks, and determine threats. For example, analytics service **624** can apply probabilistic machine learning methods to model risks associated

with an asset. An asset may be any resource or entity type, such as, for example, a person, building, space, system, equipment, device, sensor, and the like. Analytics service **624** can generate a risk score associated with an asset based on model parameters. The model parameters can be automatically updated based on feedback on the accuracy of the risk predictions. For example, the feedback may be explicit (e.g., based on questionnaires, disposition of alerts, and the like) or implicit (e.g., analyzing user actions on each threat or alert to estimate the importance of a particular event, and the like). The risk score may be stored as derived timeseries. For example, analytics service **624** (e.g., via timeseries service **628**) can generate a risk score timeseries with data values indicating the risk score at each interval of the timeseries. The risk score timeseries can be stored as derived timeseries data along with the raw timeseries data in storage **614**. The risk scores can then be retrieved, for example, by a Risk Dashboard from the timeseries service **628**.

(128) Still referring to FIG. **6**, BMS **600** is shown to include several applications **630** including an energy management application **632**, monitoring and reporting applications **634**, and enterprise control applications **636**. Although only a few applications **630** are shown, it is contemplated that applications **630** can include any of a variety of suitable applications configured to use the raw or derived timeseries generated by Cloud building management platform **620**. In some embodiments, applications **630** exist as a separate layer of BMS **600** (e.g., a part of Cloud building management platform **620** and/or data collector **612**). In other embodiments, applications **630** can exist as remote applications that run on remote systems or devices (e.g., remote systems and applications **544**, client devices **548**, and/or the like).

(129) Applications **630** can use the derived timeseries data to perform a variety data visualization, monitoring, and/or control activities. For example, energy management application **632** and monitoring and reporting application **634** can use the derived timeseries data to generate user interfaces (e.g., charts, graphs, etc.) that present the derived timeseries data to a user. In some embodiments, the user interfaces present the raw timeseries data and the derived data rollups in a single chart or graph. For example, a dropdown selector can be provided to allow a user to select the raw timeseries data or any of the data rollups for a given data point.

(130) Enterprise control application **636** can use the derived timeseries data to perform various control activities. For example, enterprise control application **636** can use the derived timeseries data as input to a control algorithm (e.g., a state-based algorithm, an extremum seeking control (ESC) algorithm, a proportional-integral (PI) control algorithm, a proportional-integral-derivative (PID) control algorithm, a model predictive control (MPC) algorithm, a feedback control algorithm, etc.) to generate control signals for building subsystems **528**. In some embodiments, building subsystems **528** use the control signals to operate building equipment. Operating the building equipment can affect the measured or calculated values of the data samples provided to BMS **600** and/or Cloud building management platform **620**. Accordingly, enterprise control application **636** can use the derived timeseries data as feedback to control the systems and devices of building subsystems **528**.

(131) Cloud Building Management Platform Entity Service

(132) Referring now to FIG. **7**, a block diagram illustrating entity service **626** in greater detail is shown, according to some embodiments. Entity service **626** registers and manages various buildings (e.g., **110-140**), spaces, persons, subsystems (e.g., **428**), devices (e.g., **112-146**), and other entities in the Cloud building management platform **620**. According to various embodiments, an entity may be any person, place, or physical object, hereafter referred to as an object entity. Further, an entity may be any event, data point, or record structure, hereinafter referred to as data entity. In addition, an entity may define a relationship between entities, hereinafter referred to as a relational entity.

(133) In some embodiments, an object entity may be defined as having at least three types of attributes. For example, an object entity may have a static attribute, a dynamic attribute, and a behavioral attribute. The static attribute may include any unique identifier of the object entity or characteristic of the object entity that either does not change over time or changes infrequently (e.g., a device ID, a person's name or social security number, a place's address or room number, and the like). The dynamic attribute may include a property of the object entity that changes over time (e.g., location, age, measurement, data point, and the like). In some embodiments, the dynamic attribute of an object entity may be linked to a data entity. In this case, the dynamic attribute of the object entity may simply refer to a location (e.g., data/network address) or static attribute (e.g., identifier) of the linked data entity, which may store the data (e.g., the value or information) of the dynamic attribute. Accordingly, in some such embodiments, when a new data point (e.g., timeseries data) is received for the object entity, only the linked data entity may be updated, while

the object entity remains unchanged. Therefore, resources that would have been expended to update the object entity may be reduced.

(134) However, the present disclosure is not limited thereto. For example, in some embodiments, there may also be some data that is updated (e.g., during predetermined intervals) in the dynamic attribute of the object entity itself. For example, the linked data entity may be configured to be updated each time a new data point is received, whereas the corresponding dynamic attribute of the object entity may be configured to be updated less often (e.g., at predetermined intervals less than the intervals during which the new data points are received). In some implementations, the dynamic attribute of the object entity may include both a link to the data entity and either a portion of the data from the data entity or data derived from the data of the data entity. For example, in an embodiment in which periodic temperature readings are received from a thermostat, an object entity corresponding to the thermostat could include the last temperature reading and a link to a data entity that stores a series of the last ten temperature readings received from the thermostat.

(135) The behavioral attribute may define a function of the object entity, for example, based on inputs, capabilities, and/or permissions. For example, behavioral attributes may define the types of inputs that the object entity is configured to accept, how the object entity is expected to respond under certain conditions, the types of functions that the object entity is capable of performing, and the like. As a non-limiting example, if the object entity represents a person, the behavioral attribute of the person may be his/her job title or job duties, user permissions to access certain systems or locations, expected location or behavior given a time of day, tendencies or preferences based on connected activity data received by entity service **626** (e.g., social media activity), and the like. As another non-limiting example, if the object entity represents a device, the behavioral attributes may include the types of inputs that the device can receive, the types of outputs that the device can generate, the types of controls that the device is capable of, the types of software or versions that the device currently has, known responses of the device to certain types of input (e.g., behavior of the device defined by its programming), and the like.

(136) In some embodiments, the data entity may be defined as having at least a static attribute and a dynamic attribute. The static attribute of the data entity may include a unique identifier or description of the data entity. For example, if the data entity is linked to a dynamic attribute of an object entity, the static attribute of the data entity may include an identifier that is used to link to the dynamic attribute of the object entity. In some embodiments, the dynamic attribute of the data entity represents the data for the dynamic attribute of the linked object entity. In some embodiments, the dynamic attribute of the data entity may represent some other data that is derived, analyzed, inferred, calculated, or determined based on data from data sources.

(137) In some embodiments, the relational entity may be defined as having at least a static attribute. The static attribute of the relational entity may semantically define the type of relationship between two or more entities. For example, in a non-limiting embodiment, a relational entity for a relationship that semantically defines that Entity A has a part of Entity B, or that Entity B is a part of Entity A may include: `hasPart{Entity A, Entity B}`

where the static attribute `hasPart` defines what the relationship is of the listed entities, and the order of the listed entities or data field of the relational entity specifies which entity is the part of the other (e.g., `Entity A.fwdarw.hasPart.fwdarw.Entity B`).

(138) In various embodiments, the relational entity is an object-oriented construct with predefined fields that define the relationship between two or more entities, regardless of the type of entities. For example, Cloud building management platform **620** can provide a rich set of pre-built entity models with standardized relational entities that can be used to describe how any two or more entities are semantically related, as well as how data is exchanged and/or processed between the entities. Accordingly, a global change to a definition or relationship of a relational entity at the system level can be effected at the object level, without having to manually change the entity relationships for each object or entity individually. Further, in some embodiments, a global change at the system level can be propagated through to third-party applications integrated with Cloud building management platform **620** such that the global change can be implemented across all of the third-party applications without requiring manual implementation of the change in each disparate application.

(139) For example, referring to FIG. **8**, an example entity graph of entity data is shown, according to some embodiments. The term “entity data” is used to describe the attributes of various entities and the relationships between the entities. For example, entity data may be represented in the form of an entity

graph. In some embodiments, entity data includes any suitable predefined data models (e.g., as a table, JSON data, and/or the like), such as entity type or object, and further includes one or more relational entities that semantically define the relationships between the entities. The relational entities may help to semantically define, for example, hierarchical or directed relationships between the entities (e.g., entity X controls entity Y, entity A feeds entity B, entity 1 is located in entity 2, and the like). For example, an object entity (e.g., IoT device) may be represented by entity type or object, which generally describes how data corresponding to the entity will be structured and stored.

(140) For example, an entity type (or object) “Thermostat” may be represented via the below schema:

(141) TABLE-US-00001 Thermostat{ Type, Model No, Device Name, Manufactured date, Serial number, MAC address, Location, Current air quality, Current indoor temperature, Current outdoor temperature, Target indoor temperature, Point schedule (e.g., BACnet schedule object) }

where various attributes are static attributes (e.g., “Type,” “Model Number,” “Device Name,” etc.), dynamic attributes (e.g., “Current air quality,” “Current outdoor temperature,” etc.), or behavioral attributes (e.g., “Target indoor temperature,” etc.) for the object entity “thermostat.” In a relational database, the object “Thermostat” is a table name, and the attributes represents column names.

(142) An example of an object entity data model for a person named John Smith in a relational database may be represented by the below table:

(143) TABLE-US-00002 First Name Last Name Tel. No. Age Location Job Title John Smith (213)220-XXXX 36 Home Engineer

where various attributes are static attributes (e.g., “First Name,” “Last Name,” etc.), dynamic attributes (e.g., “Age,” “Location,” etc.), or behavioral attributes (e.g., “Engineer”) for the object entity “John Smith.”

(144) An example data entity for the data point “Current indoor temperature” for the “Thermostat” owned by John Smith in a relational database may be represented by the below table:

(145) TABLE-US-00003 Present- Unit of Value Description Device_Type measure 68 “Current indoor temperature of Thermostat Degrees-F John's house”

where various attributes are static attributes (e.g., “Description” and “Device_Type”) and dynamic attributes (e.g., “Present-Value”).

(146) While structuring the entities via entity type or object may help to define the data representation of the entities, these data models do not provide information on how the entities relate to each other. For example, a BMS, building subsystem, or device may need data from a plurality of sources as well as information on how the sources relate to each other in order to provide a proper decision, action, or recommendation. Accordingly, in various embodiments, the entity data further includes the relational entities to semantically define the relationships between the entities, which may help to increase speeds in analyzing data, as well as provide ease of navigation and browsing.

(147) For example, still referring to FIG. 8, an entity graph 800 for the Thermostat object entity 802 includes various class entities (e.g., User, Address, SetPoint Command, and Temperature Object), relational entities (e.g., isAKindOf, Owns, isLinked, hasStorage, and hasOperation), and data entities (AI 201-01, TS ID 1, Daily Average 1, Abnormal indoor temp 1, AO 101-1, and Geo 301-01). The relational entities describe the relationships between the various class, object, and data entities in a semantic and syntactic manner, so that an application or user viewing the entity graph 800 can quickly determine the relationships and data process flow of the Thermostat object entity 802, without having to resort to a data base analyst or engineer to create, index, and/or manage the entities (e.g., using SQL or NoSQL).

(148) For example, the entity graph 800 shows that a person named John (object entity) 804 isAKindOf (relational entity) 806 User (class entity) 808. John 804 Owns (relational entity) 810 the Thermostat 802. The Thermostat 802 has a location attribute (dynamic attribute) 812 that isLinked (relational entity) 814 to Geo 301-01 (data entity) 816, which isAKindOf (relational entity) 818 an Address (class entity) 820. Accordingly, Geo 301-01 816 should have a data point corresponding to an address.

(149) The Thermostat 802 further includes a “Current indoor temperature” attribute (dynamic attribute) 822 that isLinked (relational entity) 824 to AI 201-01 (data entity) 826. AI 201-01 826 isAKindOf (relational entity) 828 Temperature Object (class entity) 830. Thus, AI 201-01 826 should contain some sort of temperature related data. AI 201-01 826 hasStorage (relational entity) 832 at TS ID 1 (data entity) 834, which may be raw or derived timeseries data for the temperature readings. AI 201-01 826

hasOperation (relational entity) **836** of Daily Average 1 (data entity) **838**, which isAKindOf (relational entity) **840** Analytic Operator (class entity) **842**. Thus, Daily Average 1 results from an analytic operation that calculates the daily average of the indoor temperature. AI **201-01 826** further hasOperation (relational entity) **854** of Abnormal Indoor Temperature (data entity) **856**, which isAKindOf (relational entity) **858** Analytic Operator (class entity) **860**. Accordingly, Abnormal Indoor Temperature results from an analytic operation to determine an abnormal temperature (e.g., exceeds or falls below a threshold value).

(150) In this example, the data entity AI **201-01 526** may be represented by the following data model:

(151) TABLE-US-00004 point { name: "AI 201-01"; type: "analog input"; value: 72; unit: "Degree-F"; source: "Temperature Sensor 1" }

where "point" is an example of a data entity that may be created by Cloud building management platform **620** to hold the value for the linked "Current indoor temperature" **822** dynamic attribute of the Thermostat entity **802**, and source is the sensor or device in the Thermostat device that provides the data to the linked "Current indoor temperature" **822** dynamic attribute.

(152) The data entity TS Id 1 **534** may be represented, for example, by the following data model:

(153) TABLE-US-00005 timeseries { name: "TS Id 1"; type: "Daily Average"; values: "[68, 20666, 70, 69, 71]; unit: "Degree-F"; point: "AI 201-01"; source: "Daily Average 1" }

where the data entity Daily Average 1 **838** represents a specific analytic operator used to create the data entity for the average daily timeseries TS Id 1 **834** based on the values of the corresponding data entity for point AI **201-01 826**. The relational entity hasOperation shows that the AI **201-01** data entity **826** is used as an input to the specific logic/math operation represented by Daily Average 1 **838**. TS Id 1 **834** might also include an attribute that identifies the analytic operator Daily Average 1 **838** as the source of the data samples in the timeseries.

(154) Still referring to FIG. 8, the entity graph **800** for Thermostat **802** shows that the "Target indoor temperature" attribute (dynamic attribute) **844** isLinked (relational attribute) **846** to the data entity AO **101-01** (data entity) **848**. AO **101-01** data entity **848** isAKindOf (relational attribute) **850** SetPoint Command (class entity) **852**. Thus, the data in data entity AO **101-01 848** may be set via a command by the user or other entity, and may be used to control the Thermostat object entity **802**. Accordingly, in various embodiments, entity graph **800** provides a user friendly view of the various relationships between the entities and data processing flow, which provides for ease of navigation, browsing, and analysis of data.

(155) Referring again to FIG. 7, entity service **626** may transform raw data samples and/or raw timeseries data into data corresponding to entity data. For example, as discussed above with reference to FIG. 8, entity service **626** can create data entities that use and/or represent data points in the timeseries data. Entity service **626** includes a web service **702**, a registration service **704**, a management service **706**, a transformation service **708**, a search service **710**, and storage **712**. In some embodiments, storage **712** may be internal storage or external storage. For example, storage **712** may be storage **614** (see FIG. 6), internal storage with relation to entity service **626**, and/or may include a remote database, cloud-based data hosting, or other remote data storage.

(156) Web service **702** can be configured to interact with web-based applications to send entity data and/or receive raw data (e.g., data samples, timeseries data, and the like). For example, web service **702** can provide an interface (e.g., API, UI/UX, and the like) to manage (e.g., register, create, edit, delete, and/or update) an entity (e.g., class entity, object entity, data entity, relational entity, and/or the like). In some embodiments, web service **702** provides entity data to web-based applications. For example, if one or more of applications **630** are web-based applications, web service **702** can provide entity data to the web-based applications. In some embodiments, web service **702** receives raw data samples and/or raw timeseries data including device information from a web-based data collector, or a web-based security service to identify authorized entities and to exchange secured messages. For example, if data collector **612** is a web-based application, web service **702** can receive the raw data samples and/or timeseries data including a device attribute indicating a type of device (e.g., IoT device) from which the data samples and/or timeseries data are received from data collector **612**. In some embodiments, web service **702** may message security service **622** to request authorization information and/or permission information of a particular user, building, BMS, building subsystem, device, application, or other entity. In some embodiments, web service **702** receives derived timeseries data from timeseries service **628**, and/or may provide entity data to timeseries service **628**. In some embodiments, the entity service **626** processes and

transforms the collected data to generate the entity data.

(157) The registration service **704** can perform registration of devices and entities. For example, registration service **704** can communicate with building subsystems **528** and client devices **548** (e.g., via web service **702**) to register each entity (e.g., building, BMS, building subsystems, devices, and the like) with Cloud building management platform **620**. In some embodiments, registration service **704** registers a particular building subsystem **528** (or the devices therein) with a specific user and/or a specific set of permissions and/or entitlements. For example, a user may register a device key and/or a device ID associated with the device via a web portal (e.g., web service **702**). In some embodiments, the device ID and the device key may be unique to the device. The device ID may be a unique number associated with the device such as a unique alphanumeric string, a serial number of the device, and/or any other static identifier. In various embodiments, the device is provisioned by a manufacturer and/or any other entity. In various embodiments, the device key and/or device ID are saved to the device or building subsystem **528** based on whether the device includes a trusted platform module (TPM). If the device includes a TPM, the device or building subsystem **528** may store the device key and/or device ID according to the protocols of the TPM. If the device does not include a TPM, the device or building subsystem **528** may store the device key and/or device ID in a file and/or file field which may be stored in a secure storage location. Further, in some embodiments, the device ID may be stored with BIOS software of the device. For example, a serial number of BIOS software may become and/or may be updated with the device ID.

(158) In various embodiments, the device key and/or the device ID are uploaded to registration service **704** (e.g., an IoT hub such as AZURE® IoT Hub). In some embodiments, registration service **704** is configured to store the device key and the device ID in secure permanent storage and/or may be stored by security service **622** (e.g., by a security API). In some embodiments, a manufacturer and/or any other individual may register the device key and the device ID with registration service **704** (e.g., via web service **702**). In various embodiments, the device key and the device ID are linked to a particular profile associated with the building subsystem **528** or device and/or a particular user profile (e.g., a particular user). In this regard, a device (or building subsystem **528**) can be associated with a particular user. In various embodiments, the device key and the device ID make up the profile for device. The profile may be registered as a device that has been manufactured and/or provisioned but has not yet been purchased by an end user.

(159) In various embodiments, registration service **704** adds and/or updates a device in an building hub device registry. In various embodiments, registration service **704** may determine if the device is already registered, can set various authentication values (e.g., device ID, device key), and can update the building hub device registry. In a similar manner, registration service **704** can update a document database with the various device registration information.

(160) In some embodiments, registration service **704** can be configured to create a virtual representation (e.g., “digital twins” or “shadow records”) of each object entity (e.g., person, room, building subsystem, device, and the like) in the building within Cloud building management platform **620**. In some embodiments, the virtual representations are smart entities that include attributes defining or characterizing the corresponding object and are associated to the corresponding object entity via relational entities defining the relationship of the object and the smart entity representation thereof. In some embodiments, the virtual representations maintain shadow copies of the object entities with versioning information so that entity service **626** can store not only the most recent update of an attribute (e.g., a dynamic attribute) associated with the object, but records of previous states of the attributes (e.g., dynamic attributes) and/or entities. For example, the shadow record may be created as a type of data entity that is related to a linked data entity corresponding to the dynamic attribute of the object entity (e.g., the person, room, building subsystem, device, and the like). For example, the shadow entity may be associated with the linked data entity via a relational entity (e.g., isLinked, hasStorage, hasOperation, and the like). In this case, the shadow entity may be used to determine additional analytics for the data point of the dynamic attribute. For example, the shadow entity may be used to determine an average value, an expected value, or an abnormal value of the data point from the dynamic attribute.

(161) Management service **706** may create, modify, or update various attributes, data entities, and/or relational entities of the objects managed by entity service **626** for each entity rather than per class or type of entity. This allows for separate processing/analytics for each individual entity rather than only to a class or type of entity. Some attributes (or data entities) may correspond to, for example, the most recent value of a data point provided to BMS **600** or Cloud building management platform **620** via the raw data

samples and/or timeseries data. For example, the “Current indoor temperature” dynamic attribute of the “Thermostat” object entity **802** in the example discussed above may be the most recent value of indoor temperature provided by the Thermostat device. Management service **706** can use the relational entities of the entity data for Thermostat to determine where to update the data of the attribute.

(162) For example, Management service **706** may determine that a data entity (e.g., AI **201-01**) is linked to the “Current indoor temperature” dynamic attribute of Thermostat via an isLinked relational entity. In this case, Management service **706** may automatically update the attribute data in the linked data entity.

Further, if a linked data entity does not exist, Management service **706** can create a data entity (e.g., AI **201-01**) and an instance of the isLinked relational entity **824** to store and link the “Current indoor temperature” dynamic attribute of Thermostat therein. Accordingly, processing/analytics for Thermostat **802** may be automated. As another example, a “most recent view” attribute (or linked data entity) of a webpage object entity may indicate the most recent time at which the webpage was viewed. Management service **706** can use the entity data from a related click tracking system object entity or web server object entity to determine when the most recent view occurred and can automatically update the “most recent view” attribute (or linked data entity) of the webpage entity accordingly.

(163) Other data entities and/or attributes may be created and/or updated as a result of an analytic, transformation, calculation, or other processing operation based on the raw data and/or entity data. For example, Management service **706** can use the relational entities in entity data to identify a related access control device (e.g., a card reader, a keypad, etc.) at the entrance/exit of a building object entity.

Management service **706** can use raw data received from the identified access control device to track the number of occupants entering and exiting the building object entity (e.g., via related card entities used by the occupants to enter and exit the building). Management service **706** can update a “number of occupants” attribute (or corresponding data entity) of the building object each time a person enters or exits the building using a related card entity, such that the “number of occupants” attribute (or data entity) reflects the current number of occupants within the building object. As another example, a “total revenue” attribute associated with a product line object may be the summation of all the revenue generated from related point of sales entities. Management service **706** can use the raw data received from the related point of sales entities to determine when a sale of the product occurs, and can identify the amount of revenue generated by the sales. Management service **706** can then update the “total revenue” attribute (or related data entity) of the product line object by adding the most recent sales revenue from each of the related point of sales entities to the previous value of the attribute.

(164) In some embodiments, management service **706** may use derived timeseries data generated from timeseries service **628** to update or create a data entity (e.g., Daily Average 1) that uses or stores the data points in the derived timeseries data. For example, the derived timeseries data may include a virtual data point corresponding to the daily average steps calculated by timeseries service **628**, and management service **706** may update the data entity or entities that store or use the data corresponding to the virtual data point as determined via the relational entities. In some embodiments, if a data entity corresponding to the virtual data point does not exist, management service **706** may automatically create a corresponding data entity and one or more relational entities that describe the relationship between the corresponding data entity and other entities.

(165) In some embodiments, management service **706** uses entity data and/or raw data from multiple different data sources to update the attributes (or corresponding data entities) of various object entities. For example, an object entity representing a person (e.g., a person's cellular device or other related object entity) may include a “risk” attribute that quantifies the person's level of risk attributable to various physical, environmental, or other conditions. Management service **706** can use relational entities of the person object entity to identify a related card device and/or a related card reader from a related building object entity (e.g., the building in which the person works) to determine the physical location of the person at any given time. Management service **706** can determine from raw data (e.g., time that the card device was scanned by the card reader) or derived timeseries data (e.g., average time of arrival) whether the person object is located in the building or may be in transit to the building. Management service **706** can associate weather data from a weather service in the region in which the building object entity is located with the building object entity, and analytics service **624** can generate a risk score for the possibility that any severe weather is approaching the person's location based on the associated weather data, building entity, and person entity. Similarly, management service **706** can associate building data from related

building entities with the building object entity, and analytics service **624** can determine whether the building in which the person is located is experiencing any emergency conditions (e.g., fire, building lockdown, etc.) or environmental hazards (e.g., detected air contaminants, pollutants, extreme temperatures, etc.) that could increase the person's level of risk. Management service **706** can provide these and other types of data to analytics service **624** as inputs to a risk function that calculates the value of the person object's "risk" attribute and can update the person object (or related device entity of the person object) accordingly.

(166) In some embodiments, management service **706** can be configured to synchronize configuration settings, parameters, and other device-specific or object-specific information between the entities and Cloud building management platform **620**. In some embodiments, the synchronization occurs asynchronously. Management service **706** can be configured to manage device properties dynamically. The device properties, configuration settings, parameters, and other device-specific information can be synchronized between the smart entities created by and stored within Cloud building management platform **620**.

(167) In some embodiments, management service **706** is configured to manage a manifest for each of the building subsystems **528** (or devices therein). The manifest may include a set of relationships between the building subsystems **528** and various entities. Further, the manifest may indicate a set of entitlements for the building subsystems **528** and/or entitlements of the various entities and/or other entities. The set of entitlements may allow a BMS **600**, building subsystem **528** and/or a user to perform certain actions within the building or (e.g., control, configure, monitor, and/or the like).

(168) Still referring to FIG. 7, transformation service **708** can provide data virtualization, and can transform various predefined standard data models for entities in a same class or type to have the same entity data structure, regardless of the object, device, or Thing that the entity represents. For example, each object entity under an object class may include a location attribute, regardless of whether or not the location attribute is used or even generated. Thus, if an application is later developed requiring that each object entity includes a location attribute, manual mapping of heterogeneous data of different entities in the same class may be avoided. Accordingly, interoperability and scalability of applications may be improved.

(169) In some embodiments, transformation service **708** can provide entity matching, cleansing, and correlation so that a unified cleansed view of the entity data including the entity related information (e.g., relational entities) can be provided. Transformation service **708** can support semantic and syntactic relationship description in the form of standardized relational entities between the various entities. This may simplify machine learning because the relational entities themselves provide all the relationship description between the other entities. Accordingly, the rich set of pre-built entity models and standardized relational entities may provide for rapid application development and data analytics.

(170) Still referring to FIG. 7, the search service **710** provides a unified view of product related information in the form of the entity graph, which correlates entity relationships (via relational entities) among multiple data sources (e.g., CRM, ERP, MRP and the like). In some embodiments, the search service **710** is based on a schema-less and graph based indexing architecture. The search service **710** facilitates simple queries without having to search multiple levels of the hierarchical tree of the entity graph. For example, search service **710** can return results based on searching of entity type, individual entities, attributes, or even relational entities without requiring other levels or entities of the hierarchy to be searched.

(171) Timeseries Data Platform Service

(172) Referring now to FIG. 9, a block diagram illustrating timeseries service **628** in greater detail is shown, according to some embodiments. Timeseries service **628** is shown to include a timeseries web service **902**, an events service **903**, a timeseries processing engine **904**, and a timeseries storage interface **916**. Timeseries web service **902** can be configured to interact with web-based applications to send and/or receive timeseries data. In some embodiments, timeseries web service **902** provides timeseries data to web-based applications. For example, if one or more of applications **630** are web-based applications, timeseries web service **902** can provide derived timeseries data and/or raw timeseries data to the web-based applications. In some embodiments, timeseries web service **902** receives raw timeseries data from a web-based data collector. For example, if data collector **612** is a web-based application, timeseries web service **902** can receive raw data samples or raw timeseries data from data collector **612**. In some

embodiments, timeseries web service **902** and entity service web service **702** may be integrated as parts of the same web service.

(173) Timeseries storage interface **916** can be configured to store and read samples of various timeseries (e.g., raw timeseries data and derived timeseries data) and eventseries (described in greater detail below). Timeseries storage interface **916** can interact with storage **614**. For example, timeseries storage interface **916** can retrieve timeseries data from a timeseries database **928** within storage **614**. In some embodiments, timeseries storage interface **916** reads samples from a specified start time or start position in the timeseries to a specified stop time or a stop position in the timeseries. Similarly, timeseries storage interface **916** can retrieve eventseries data from an eventseries database **929** within storage **614**. Timeseries storage interface **916** can also store timeseries data in timeseries database **928** and can store eventseries data in eventseries database **929**. Advantageously, timeseries storage interface **916** provides a consistent interface which enables logical data independence.

(174) In some embodiments, timeseries storage interface **916** stores timeseries as lists of data samples, organized by time. For example, timeseries storage interface **916** can store timeseries in the following format: [`<key, timestamp.sub.1, value.sub.1>`, `<key, timestamp.sub.2, value.sub.2>`, `<key, timestamp.sub.3, value.sub.3>`]

where key is an identifier of the source of the data samples (e.g., timeseries ID, sensor ID, device ID, etc.), timestamp.sub.i identifies a time associated with the ith sample, and value.sub.i indicates the value of the ith sample.

(175) In some embodiments, timeseries storage interface **916** stores eventseries as lists of events having a start time, an end time, and a state. For example, timeseries storage interface **916** can store eventseries in the following format: [`<eventID.sub.1, start_timestamp.sub.1, end_timestamp.sub.1, state.sub.1>`, . . . , `<eventID.sub.N, start_timestamp.sub.N, end_timestamp.sub.N, state.sub.N>`]

where eventID.sub.i is an identifier of the ith event, start_timestamp.sub.i is the time at which the ith event started, end_timestamp.sub.i is the time at which the ith event ended, state.sub.i describes a state or condition associated with the ith event (e.g., cold, hot, warm, etc.), and N is the total number of events in the eventseries.

(176) In some embodiments, timeseries storage interface **916** stores timeseries and eventseries in a tabular format. Timeseries storage interface **916** can store timeseries and eventseries in various tables having a column for each attribute of the timeseries/eventseries samples (e.g., key, timestamp, value). The timeseries tables can be stored in timeseries database **928**, whereas the eventseries tables can be stored in eventseries database **929**. In some embodiments, timeseries storage interface **916** caches older data to storage **614** but stores newer data in RAM. This may improve read performance when the newer data are requested for processing.

(177) In some embodiments, timeseries storage interface **916** omits one or more of the attributes when storing the timeseries samples. For example, timeseries storage interface **916** may not need to repeatedly store the key or timeseries ID for each sample in the timeseries. In some embodiments, timeseries storage interface **916** omits timestamps from one or more of the samples. If samples of a particular timeseries have timestamps at regular intervals (e.g., one sample each minute), timeseries storage interface **916** can organize the samples by timestamps and store the values of the samples in a row. The timestamp of the first sample can be stored along with the interval between the timestamps. Timeseries storage interface **916** can determine the timestamp of any sample in the row based on the timestamp of the first sample and the position of the sample in the row.

(178) In some embodiments, timeseries storage interface **916** stores one or more samples with an attribute indicating a change in value relative to the previous sample value. The change in value can replace the actual value of the sample when the sample is stored in timeseries database **928**. This allows timeseries storage interface **916** to use fewer bits when storing samples and their corresponding values. Timeseries storage interface **916** can determine the value of any sample based on the value of the first sample and the change in value of each successive sample.

(179) In some embodiments, timeseries storage interface **916** invokes entity service **626** to create data entities in which samples of timeseries data and/or eventseries data can be stored. The data entities can include JSON objects or other types of data objects to store one or more timeseries samples and/or eventseries samples. Timeseries storage interface **916** can be configured to add samples to the data entities and read samples from the data entities. For example, timeseries storage interface **916** can receive a set of

samples from data collector **612**, entity service **626**, timeseries web service **902**, events service **903**, and/or timeseries processing engine **904**. Timeseries storage interface **916** can add the set of samples to a data entity by sending the samples to entity service **626** to be stored in the data entity, for example, or may directly interface with the data entity to add/modify the sample to the data entity.

(180) Timeseries storage interface **916** can use data entities when reading samples from storage **614**. For example, timeseries storage interface **916** can retrieve a set of samples from storage **614** or from entity service **626**, and add the samples to a data entity (e.g., directly or via entity service **626**). In some embodiments, the set of samples include all samples within a specified time period (e.g., samples with timestamps in the specified time period) or eventseries samples having a specified state. Timeseries storage interface **916** can provide the samples in the data entity to timeseries web service **902**, events service **903**, timeseries processing engine **904**, applications **630**, and/or other components configured to use the timeseries/eventseries samples.

(181) Still referring to FIG. **9**, timeseries processing engine **904** is shown to include several timeseries operators **906**. Timeseries operators **906** can be configured to apply various operations, transformations, or functions to one or more input timeseries to generate output timeseries and/or eventseries. The input timeseries can include raw timeseries data and/or derived timeseries data. Timeseries operators **906** can be configured to calculate aggregate values, averages, or apply other mathematical operations to the input timeseries. In some embodiments, timeseries operators **906** generate virtual point timeseries by combining two or more input timeseries (e.g., adding the timeseries together), creating multiple output timeseries from a single input timeseries, or applying mathematical operations to the input timeseries. In some embodiments, timeseries operators **906** perform data cleansing operations or deduplication operations on an input timeseries. In some embodiments, timeseries operators **906** use the input timeseries to generate eventseries based on the values of the timeseries samples. The output timeseries can be stored as derived timeseries data in storage **614** as one or more timeseries data entities. Similarly, the eventseries can be stored as eventseries data entities in storage **614**.

(182) In some embodiments, timeseries operators **906** do not change or replace the raw timeseries data, but rather generate various “views” of the raw timeseries data (e.g., as separate data entities) with corresponding relational entities defining the relationships between the raw timeseries data entity and the various views data entities. The views can be queried in the same manner as the raw timeseries data. For example, samples can be read from the raw timeseries data entity, transformed to create the view entity, and then provided as an output. Because the transformations used to create the views can be computationally expensive, the views can be stored as “materialized view” data entities in timeseries database **928**. Instances of relational entities can be created to define the relationship between the raw timeseries data entity and the materialize view data entities. These materialized views are referred to as derived data timeseries throughout the present disclosure.

(183) Timeseries operators **906** can be configured to run at query time (e.g., when a request for derived data timeseries is received) or prior to query time (e.g., when new raw data samples are received, in response to a defined event or trigger, etc.). This flexibility allows timeseries operators **906** to perform some or all of their operations ahead of time and/or in response to a request for specific derived data timeseries. For example, timeseries operators **906** can be configured to pre-process one or more timeseries that are read frequently to ensure that the timeseries are updated whenever new data samples are received, and the pre-processed timeseries may be stored in a corresponding data entity for retrieval. However, timeseries operators **906** can be configured to wait until query time to process one or more timeseries that are read infrequently to avoid performing unnecessary processing operations.

(184) In some embodiments, timeseries operators **906** are triggered in a particular sequence defined by a directed acyclic graph (DAG). The DAG may define a workflow or sequence of operations or transformations to apply to one or more input timeseries. For example, the DAG for a raw data timeseries may include a data cleansing operation, an aggregation operation, and a summation operation (e.g., adding two raw data timeseries to create a virtual point timeseries). The DAGs can be stored in a DAG database **930** within storage **614**, or internally within timeseries processing engine **904**. DAGs can be retrieved by workflow manager **922** and used to determine how and when to process incoming data samples.

Exemplary systems and methods for creating and using DAGs are described in greater detail below.

(185) Timeseries operators **906** can perform aggregations for dashboards, cleansing operations, logical operations for rules and fault detection, machine learning predictions or classifications, call out to external

services, or any of a variety of other operations which can be applied to timeseries data. The operations performed by timeseries operators **906** are not limited to timeseries data. Timeseries operators **906** can also operate on event data or function as a billing engine for a consumption or tariff-based billing system.

Timeseries operators **906** are shown to include a sample aggregator **908**, a virtual point calculator **910**, a weather point calculator **912**, a fault detector **914**, and an eventseries generator **915**.

(186) Still referring to FIG. **9**, timeseries processing engine **904** is shown to include a DAG optimizer **918**. DAG optimizer **918** can be configured to combine multiple DAGs or multiple steps of a DAG to improve the efficiency of the operations performed by timeseries operators **906**. For example, suppose that a DAG has one functional block which adds “Timeseries A” and “Timeseries B” to create “Timeseries C” (i.e., $A+B=C$) and another functional block which adds “Timeseries C” and “Timeseries D” to create “Timeseries E” (i.e., $C+D=E$). DAG optimizer **918** can combine these two functional blocks into a single functional block which computes “Timeseries E” directly from “Timeseries A,” “Timeseries B,” and “Timeseries D” (i.e., $E=A+B+D$). Alternatively, both “Timeseries C” and “Timeseries E” can be computed in the same functional block to reduce the number of independent operations required to process the DAG.

(187) In some embodiments, DAG optimizer **918** combines DAGs or steps of a DAG in response to a determination that multiple DAGs or steps of a DAG will use similar or shared inputs (e.g., one or more of the same input timeseries). This allows the inputs to be retrieved and loaded once rather than performing two separate operations that both load the same inputs. In some embodiments, DAG optimizer **918** schedules timeseries operators **906** to nodes where data is resident in memory in order to further reduce the amount of data required to be loaded from the timeseries database **928**.

(188) Timeseries processing engine **904** is shown to include a directed acyclic graph (DAG) generator **920**. DAG generator **920** can be configured to generate one or more DAGs for each raw data timeseries. Each DAG may define a workflow or sequence of operations which can be performed by timeseries operators **906** on the raw data timeseries. When new samples of the raw data timeseries are received, workflow manager **922** can retrieve the corresponding DAG and use the DAG to determine how the raw data timeseries should be processed. In some embodiments, the DAGs are declarative views which represent the sequence of operations applied to each raw data timeseries. The DAGs may be designed for timeseries rather than structured query language (SQL).

(189) In some embodiments, DAGs apply over windows of time. For example, the timeseries processing operations defined by a DAG may include a data aggregation operation that aggregates a plurality of raw data samples having timestamps within a given time window. The start time and end time of the time window may be defined by the DAG and the timeseries to which the DAG is applied. The DAG may define the duration of the time window over which the data aggregation operation will be performed. For example, the DAG may define the aggregation operation as an hourly aggregation (i.e., to produce an hourly data rollup timeseries), a daily aggregation (i.e., to produce a daily data rollup timeseries), a weekly aggregation (i.e., to produce a weekly data rollup timeseries), or any other aggregation duration. The position of the time window (e.g., a specific day, a specific week, etc.) over which the aggregation is performed may be defined by the timestamps of the data samples of timeseries provided as an input to the DAG.

(190) In operation, sample aggregator **908** can use the DAG to identify the duration of the time window (e.g., an hour, a day, a week, etc.) over which the data aggregation operation will be performed. Sample aggregator **908** can use the timestamps of the data samples in the timeseries provided as an input to the DAG to identify the location of the time window (i.e., the start time and the end time). Sample aggregator **908** can set the start time and end time of the time window such that the time window has the identified duration and includes the timestamps of the data samples. In some embodiments, the time windows are fixed, having predefined start times and end times (e.g., the beginning and end of each hour, day, week, etc.). In other embodiments, the time windows may be sliding time windows, having start times and end times that depend on the timestamps of the data samples in the input timeseries.

(191) FIG. **10** is an example entity graph of entity data according to an embodiment of the present disclosure. The example of FIG. **10** assumes that an HVAC fault detection application has detected an abnormal temperature measurement with respect to Temperature Sensor **1012**. However, Temperature Sensor **1012** itself may be operating properly, but may rely on various factors, conditions, and other systems and devices to measure the temperature properly. Accordingly, for example, the HVAC fault detection application may need to know the room **1014** in which the Temperature Sensor **1012** is located,

the corresponding temperature setpoint, the status of the VAV **1004** that supplies conditioned air to the room **1014**, the status of the AHU **1002** that feeds the VAV **1004**, the status of the vents in the HVAC zone **1010**, etc., in order to pin point the cause of the abnormal measurement. Thus, the HVAC fault detection application may require additional information from various related subsystems and devices (e.g., entity objects), as well as the zones and rooms (e.g., entity objects) that the subsystems and devices are configured to serve, to properly determine or infer the cause of the abnormal measurement.

(192) Referring to FIG. **10**, entity graph **1000** shows the relationship between Temperature Sensor **1012** and related entities via relational entities (e.g., feeds, hasPoint, hasPart, Controls, etc.). For example, entity graph **1000** shows that Temperature Sensor **1012** provides temperature readings (e.g., hasPoint) to the VAV **1004** and the HVAC Zone **1010**. An AHU **1002** provides (e.g., feeds) the VAV **1004** with chilled and/or heated air. The AHU **1002** receives/provides power readings (e.g., hasPoint) from/to a Power Meter **1008**. The VAV **1004** provides (e.g., feeds) air to HVAC Zone **1010** using (e.g., hasPart) a Damper **1006**. The HVAC Zone **1010** provides the air to Room **1014**. Further, Rooms **1014** and **1020** are located in (e.g., hasPart) Lighting Zone **1018**, which is controlled (e.g., controls) by Lighting Controller **1016**.

(193) Accordingly, in the example of FIG. **10**, in response to receiving the faulty measurement from Temperature Sensor **1012**, the HVAC fault detection application and/or analytics service **624** can determine from the entity graph that the fault could be caused by some malfunction in one or more of the other related entities, and not necessarily a malfunction of the Temperature Sensor **1012**. Thus, the HVAC fault detection application and/or the analytics service **624** can further investigate into the other related entities to determine or infer the most likely cause of the fault.

(194) Building Information Management System

(195) Referring now to FIG. **11**, the cloud entity service **626** of FIG. **6** is shown in greater detail implementing information management with mask templates, according to an exemplary embodiment. While FIG. **11**, and generally FIGS. **11-18**, describe the information management being performed by the cloud entity service **626**, any computing device as described herein can be configured to perform the information management as described with reference to FIGS. **11-18**. For example, the security service **622** as described with reference to FIG. **6**, can be configured to perform some and/or all of the operations of the cloud entity service **626** as described with reference to FIGS. **11-18**. The cloud entity service **626** is in communication with the client devices **548** as described with reference to FIG. **5**. The client devices **548** can be in communication with the cloud entity service **626** via the network **546** as described with further reference to FIG. **6**.

(196) The client devices **548** can be in communication with the cloud entity service **626** via an interface application **1100**. The interface application **1100** is configured to operate on the client devices **548** or otherwise on other devices (e.g., a web server, the building management system **600**, the cloud building management platform **620**, etc.) in some embodiments. In some embodiments, the interface application **1100** is one or multiple of the applications **630** (e.g., the energy management application **632**, the monitoring & reporting application **634**, and/or the enterprise control application **636**). In some embodiments, the interface application **1100** is a risk management application for reviewing risk (e.g., risk for a specific threat event, e.g., a fire, storm, etc.). Risk applications are described with further reference in U.S. Provisional Application No. 62/628,647, filed Feb. 9, 2018, U.S. Provisional Application No. 62/628,711 filed Feb. 9, 2018, and U.S. Provisional Application No. 62/637,954 filed Mar. 2, 2018, the entirety of each of these applications is incorporated by reference herein in their entireties.

(197) The cloud entity service **626** includes an external interface **1102** in some embodiments. The external interface **1102** can be a software and/or hardware component configured to interface cloud entity service **626** with the client devices **548**. For example, the external interface **1102** can be, or can include, the communications interface **602** as described with reference to FIG. **6**. In some embodiments, the external interface **1102** is and/or includes an application programming interface (API). In some embodiments, the external interface **1102** is configured to manage information request **1146** received from client devices **548** and provide a masked response **1148** to the client devices **548** in response to receiving the information request **1146**.

(198) The information request **1146** can be a request for private information for a particular entity of entity database **1124**. The information request **1146** can be generated by the client devices **548** and/or the interface application **1100**. In some embodiments, rather than a client device generating the information request **1146**, another system and/or computing device can generate the information request **1146** and/or

provide the information request **1146** to the external interface **1102**. For example, the information request **1146** can be generated by another component of cloud building management platform **620**, by the building management system **600**, by building subsystems **528**, by 3.sup.rd party services **550**, by BMS controller **466**, and/or any other computing device as described herein.

(199) The information request **1146** can identify a particular building entity (e.g., entity **1126**) and/or be a request for specific private information (or generally all private information) for the particular building entity. The information request **1146** can include, or can be related to, access values **1104**. The access values can be provided by the client devices **548** and/or the interface application **1100** to external interface **1102**. In some embodiments, a username and/or password (or other identifying information) is provided by the client devices **548** and/or the interface application **1100** to the external interface **1102**. Based on the identifying information, the external interface **1102** can be configured to retrieve the access values **1104** associated with the identifying information. In this regard, the external interface **1102** may store a list of login credentials and linked access values **1104** for each of the login credentials.

(200) The access values **1104** can be one or more values that masking engine **1118** can be configured to utilize to select one mask template of the mask templates **1128**. The access values **1104** can be and/or can include a role identifier **1106**, a geographic location identifier **1108**, a vertical identifier **1110**, and/or an application identifier **1112**. The role identifier **1106** can be a value indicative of a particular role of a user of the client devices **548**. For example, if the user is a building occupant, the role identifier **1106** may be a “Building Occupant” role. If the user is a building owner, the role may be a “Building Owner” role. Other role identifiers **1106** may be a tenant role, a super user role, a technician role, and/or any other role. The role may be indicative of the level of access, or specific tailored amounts of access, that the user should be allowed to have.

(201) The geographic location identifier **1108** may be indicative of a location of the client devices **548**. For example, in some embodiments, the geographic location identifier **1108** may be indicative of a particular geographic location (e.g., a state, a country, a coordinate, etc.). The geographic location identifier **1108** can be based on an Internet Protocol (IP) address associated with the client devices **548**, can be a reported coordinate generated by a global positioning system (GPS) of the client devices **548**, can be programmed into the external interface **1102** for a specific device, etc.

(202) The vertical identifier **1110** may identify a particular business use of the client devices **548** and/or a particular business associated with the user of the client devices **548**. For example, if the user is a health care professional (e.g., a doctor, a nurse, a surgeon, etc.) and/or the client devices **548** or an account associate with the client devices **548** is associated with a hospital, a hospice, or a rehabilitation center, the vertical identifier **1110** may be a “Health Care” vertical. Similarly, if the user of the client devices **548** is a building tenant or a landlord and/or the client devices **548** are used to access an interface associated with an apartment or rented property, the vertical identifier **1110** may be an “Apartment” vertical.

(203) The application identifier **1112** can identify the specific type of interface application **1100** that the client devices **548** utilize to communicate with the cloud entity service **626**. For example, if the interface application **1100** is a web browser, the application identifier **1112** may be “Web Browser.” If the interface application **1100** is a resident portal (or the interface application **1100** connects to a resident portal), the application identifier **1112** may be “Resident Portal.” Furthermore, the interface application **1100** may be a security monitoring application for a security system, the application identifier **1112** may be “Security Monitoring Application.”

(204) The access values **1104** are provided to the masking engine **1118** for generating the masked response **1148** in some embodiments. Furthermore, an access hash key **1116** is provided to the masking engine **1118** in some embodiments. The access hash key **1116** can be generated by hash manager **1114** and provided by the hash manager **1114** to the masking engine **1118**. The hash manager **1114** can be configured to generate the access hash key **1116** based on some and/or all of the access values **1104**. For example, the hash manager **1114** can be configured to concatenate some and/or all of the access values **1104** together and hash the concatenated access values. Examples of hashing algorithms that the hash manager **1114** can be configured to perform to generate the access hash key **1116** based on the access values **1104** can be SHA-224, SHA-256, Pearson hashing, Buzhash, HMAC, MD6, MD5, and/or any other type of cryptographic or non-cryptographic hashing algorithm.

(205) The masking engine **1118** can be configured to receive the access values **1104** from the external interface **1102** and/or receive the access hash key **1116** from the hash manager **1114**. Based on the access

values **1104** and/or the access hash key **1116**, the masking engine **1118** can be configured to retrieve private information for the information request **1146**, retrieve one of the mask templates **1128**, and generate the masked response **1148** based on the retrieved mask template and the retrieved private information. The masking engine **1118** can be configured to implement one or multiple masking operators of the mask templates **1128** to mask the private information. In some embodiments, each of the masking operators of the mask templates **1128** corresponds to a specific private data attribute. In this regard, the masking engine **1118** can apply each of the masking operators to a specific private data attribute to generate the masked response **1148**.

(206) In some embodiments, the masking engine **1118** is implemented within the cloud entity service **626**. However, in some embodiments, the masking engine **1118** is implemented in various devices (e.g., in a building device, in a particular domain, in a particular application, in a database, etc.) such that the masking engine **1118** can send a request to the cloud entity service **626** for a particular mask, retrieve the mask, and then mask local and/or information of the cloud entity service **626** with the mask.

(207) The masking engine **1118** includes a mask retriever **1138** in some embodiments. The mask retriever **1138** can be configured to retrieve a mask template of the mask templates **1128** based on the access values **1104** and/or the access hash key **1116**. The mask retriever **1138** can be configured to store a mask retrieval structure which associates each combination of access values **1104** (or value for access hash key **1116**) with a particular mask template of the mask templates **1128**. The mask retrieval structure is described with greater detail in FIG. 12. In some embodiments, instead of, and/or in addition to, a mask retrieval data structure, the mask retriever **1138** can be configured to search the mask templates **1128** based on the access hash key **1116** and/or the access values **1104** to identify a mask template of the mask templates **1128** that corresponds to the access hash key **1116** and/or the access values **1104** (e.g., each of the mask templates **1128** may store specific values for the access values **1104** and/or the access hash key **1116** and the masking engine **1118** can determine whether some and/or all of particular access values **1104** match specific access and/or hash key values of one of the mask templates **1128**).

(208) The cloud entity service **626** includes the entity database **1124**. The entity database **1124** may store one or multiple data structures of interrelated entities. The entity database **1124** may be the same as and/or similar to the entity graph **800** as described with reference to FIG. 8, the storage **712** as described with reference to FIG. 7, and/or the entity graph **1000** as described with reference to FIG. 10. The entity database **1124** can store data structures (e.g., class entities, relational entities, object entities, and/or data entities) as described with reference to FIGS. 8 and 10 and elsewhere herein. Class entities can be user entities, address entities, a setpoint command, a temperature object, a building entity, etc. while an object entity may be a particular instance of the class entity. A relational entity can be a relation between two object entities, an object entity and a data entity, an object entity and a class entity and may be isAKindOf, Owns, isLinked, hasStorage, hasOperation, hasA, isRelatedTo, and/or any other kind of semantic relationship. The data entities can be attributes e.g., analog inputs, virtual data points, private information, etc.

(209) The entity database **1124** includes an entity **1126**. The entity **1126** may be an object entity (e.g., a user, a building, a device, etc.). The entity **1126** isAKindOf **1144** (relational entity) entity type **1132** (class entity). For example, entity **1126** could be a particular thermostat object entity and can be based on a thermostat entity class via a relational entity (i.e., isAKindOf **1144**). Furthermore, the entity **1126** could be a particular person object entity, John Smith, and can be based on a user class entity.

(210) The entity **1126** hasA **1143** (relational entity) access control list (ACL) **1136** (data entity). The ACL **1136** can store one or multiple identifiers identifying a particular principle (e.g., role, application, username) that has access to the entity **1126**. For example, the ACL may indicate that only certain roles have access to the private information **1134** of entity **1126**. For example, only Super User roles have access to the private information **1134** of the entity **1126**. In this regard, the mask retriever **1138** may first determine whether the role identifier **1106** is a role indicated by the ACL **1136** for the entity **1126**. In response to a determination that the role identifier **1106** has access to the entity **1126**, the mask retriever **1138** can retrieve the appropriate mask template of mask templates **1128** and mask the private information **1134** with the retrieved mask template of the mask templates **1128**.

(211) Entity **1126** hasA **1142** (relational entity) private information **1134**. The private information **1134** may be, or may be indicative of, private information of the entity **1126**. In some embodiments, the entity database **1124** stores the private information **1134** directly. In some embodiments, the entity database **1124**

stores a relational link between the private information **1134** and encrypted private information stored in encrypted data storage **1122**. For example, the private information **1134** may be a link to actual encrypted data stored in encrypted data storage **1122**. In this regard, in retrieving the private information **1134** from entity database **1124**, masking engine **1118** can be configured to retrieve and/or decrypt actual private information stored in the encrypted data storage **1122** based on the private information **1134** which is a link (e.g., handle) to the actual encrypted data in the encrypted data storage **1122**.

(212) The private information **1134** may be an encryption key, a password, a social security number, a username, a password, login credentials, a data point, a telephone number, an address, marital status, age, height, work address, work telephone number, email address, date of birth, birthplace, country of residence, gender, race, passport number, credit card number, banking information, criminal record, job position title, grade information, salary, tax bracket, work permit information, visa status, citizenship, genetic information, genetic code, eye color, retinal data, image of handwritten signature, facial image data, finger print data, medical history, medical prescriptions, vehicle registration number, driver license number, license plate number, network address (e.g., IP address, MAC address, BACnet address), device name, device owner, device identifier, device configuration data, temperature setpoint, pressure setpoint, humidity setpoint, temperature data, timeseries data, occupancy data, air quality data, and/or any other kind of private data.

(213) The entity **1126** hasA **1140** (relational entity) mask templates **1128**. The relational entity hasA **1140** can establish a link between the entity **1126** and the mask templates **1128** specific for the entity **1126**. In this regard, in response to the information request **1146**, the masking engine **1118** can determine which mask templates are appropriate for masking the private information **1134** by identifying the relationships of entity **1126**. The masking engine **1118** can identify that mask templates **1128** are the appropriate set of mask templates (the entity database **1124** may store multiple sets of mask templates, each linked to various entities) and can select one of the mask templates **1128** for masking the private information **1134**.

(214) The cloud entity service **626** includes the encrypted data storage **1122** in some embodiments. In some embodiments, the encrypted data storage **1122** stores some and/or all of the entity database **1124** in encrypted form. For example, all of the class entities, object entities, relational entities, and data entities can be encrypted by the cloud entity service **626** and stored in the encrypted data storage **1122**. The cloud entity service **626** can be configured to generate the entity database **1124** by decrypting the encrypted class entities, object entities, relational entities, and/or data entities. In some embodiments, only some of the class entities, object entities, relational entities, and/or data entities are stored in the encrypted data storage **1122**. For example, the private information **1134** may be encrypted and stored in the encrypted data storage **1122**. The masking engine **1118** can be configured to retrieve and/or decrypt the encrypted private information stored in the encrypted data storage **1122**.

(215) In some embodiments, the masking engine **1118** can be configured to determine whether the information of the information request **1146** is a request for public information or a request for private information. The masking engine **1118** can be configured to determine, based on the information request **1146**, whether the masking engine **1118** needs to be implemented or not. If the information request **1146** is a request for the private information **1134** (e.g., information marked as private information by the entity database **1124**), the masking engine **1118** can be configured to apply one of the mask templates **1128** on the private information **1134** and provide the masked response **1148** to the client devices **548**. If the information request **1146** is a request for information linked to the entity **1126** that is marked as public information, the masking engine **1118** can be configured to provide the public information to the client devices **548** without masking the public information.

(216) For example, the entity **1126** can be linked to various data entities. Each of the data entities may indicate whether the data is private or public. For example, the private information **1134** may be private while another data entity, a public data entity, can be linked (via a hasA relational entity) to the entity **1126**. The public data entity can include an indication that the data entity is public. In this regard, the masking engine **1118** can determine, based on the entity database **1124**, specifically, based on the data entities, whether the data is public or private.

(217) In some embodiments, the information request **1146** identifies a particular entity of the entity database **1124** (e.g., the entity **1126**) and includes a request for private information (or specific information) related to the entity **1126**. In this regard, the masking engine **1118** can determine to retrieve the private information **1134** since the private information **1134** is linked to the entity **1126** via hasA **1142**.

Furthermore, the masking engine **1118** can determine to retrieve one off the mask templates **1128** since the mask templates **1128** are linked to the entity **1126** via hasA **1140**.

(218) Similarly, in some embodiments, the information request **1146** may include a request for specific information, e.g., a direct request for the private information **1134**. In this regard, the masking engine **1118** can determine to retrieve the private information **1134** since the information request **1146** indicates the private information **1134**. Furthermore, the masking engine **1118** can determine to retrieve one of the mask templates **1128** since the masking engine **1118** can determine that the mask templates **1128** are linked to the private information **1134**, i.e., the entity **1126** is linked to the mask templates **1128** and the private information **1134**.

(219) Referring now to FIG. 12, FIG. 12 includes a mask retrieval structure **1200** for retrieving one of the mask templates **1128** (mask templates **1208-1214**), according to an exemplary embodiment. In some embodiments, the mask retrieval structure **1200** is implemented by the mask retriever **1138** as a lookup table for selecting a particular mask template of the mask templates **1128** as a function of the access values **1104** and/or the access hash key **1116**. However, in some embodiments, the masking engine **1118** performs a search of the mask templates **1128** (each mask template storing a particular value for the access values **1104** and/or the access hash key **1116**) and may not require the mask retrieval structure **1200**. Regardless, the mask retrieval structure **1200** provides an example of the linkage between access values **1104** and/or the access hash key **1116** and the mask templates **1128** that can exist and can be identified via a search of the mask templates **1128**.

(220) In FIG. 12, each row of the mask retrieval structure **1200** is associated with a particular mask template of the mask templates **1128** in some embodiments. The mask template can be associated with the particular row of the mask retrieval structure **1200** is a function of the values of the row (e.g., role, application, access hash). The mask retrieval structure includes a column **1202** for the role identifier **1106** and a column **1204** for the application identifier **1112**. Furthermore, the mask retrieval structure includes a column **1206** for the access hash key **1116**. The mask retrieval structure **1200** can include any number of columns for any number of the access values **1104**.

(221) A particular role “Super User” and a particular application “Mobile Application” is linked to the mask template **1208**. In some embodiments, the mask template **1208** includes the indication of “Super User” and the indication of “Mobile Application” in addition to multiple masking operators for masking private information. The masking engine **1118** can be configured search the mask templates **1128** (and/or the mask retrieval structure **1200**) with the role identifier **1106** “Super User” and the application identifier **1112** “Mobile Application” and retrieve the mask template **1208** if the role identifier **1106** stored by the mask template **1208** has the value “Super User” and the application identifier **1112** stored by the mask template **1208** has the value “Mobile Application.” Furthermore, mask retrieval structure **1200** can include an access hash “716a” which may correspond to a hash of “Super User” concatenated with “Mobile Application.” The mask template **1208** may, in some embodiments, store the access hash “716a” such that the masking engine **1118** can be configured to search the mask templates **1128** with the access hash key **1116** and retrieve the mask template **1208** if the access hash key **1116** stored by the mask template **1208** has the value “716a.”

(222) Referring now to FIG. 13, a block diagram of the private information **1134** and the masked response **1148** is shown, according to an exemplary embodiment. The private information **1134** can include multiple attributes, attribute **1302**, attribute **1304**, and attribute **1306**. The private information **1134** can be any number of attributes. The attributes **1302-1306** can be any kind of private information, e.g., a phone number, a birthdate, a social security number, an address, a user name, a full name, an encryption key, a device identifier, a network address, a temperature data point, a humidity data point, a virtual point, and/or any other kind of information. Each of the attributes **1302-1306** map directly to one of masked attributes **1310-1314** of the masked response **1148**. The masked attributes are clear text **1310**, clear text portion **1312**, and not shown **1314**.

(223) The clear text **1310** may be the exact value of attribute **1302** with no encryption and/or masking, i.e., it can be the attribute **1302** shown in the clear. For example, if the value of attribute **1302** is “John Smith” clear text **1310** may also be “John Smith.” A clear text masking operator can be implemented by a particular mask of the mask templates **1128** to show the attribute **1302** as the clear text **1310**.

(224) The clear text portion **1312** can be a portion of the attribute **1304** shown in the clear. In some embodiments, only some of the characters or values of the attribute **1304** are shown in the clear text

portion **1312**. In some embodiments, some of the characters or values of the attribute **1304** are masked with a reference character (e.g., “*”) For example, if the attribute **1304** is “John Smith” the clear text portion **1312** may be “John Smi” or “John Sm**.” For example, one masking operator of one of the mask templates **1128** may remove some of the characters and/or values of the attribute **1304** to generate the clear text portion **1312** while another (or the same) masking operator can replace some of the characters and/or values of the attribute **1304** with a “*.”

(225) Furthermore, the attribute **1306** can map to the not shown attribute **1314**. The not shown attribute **1314** may be an empty data set, and/or may not be any attribute at all. In this regard, the masking engine **1118** can fully mask, e.g., remove, the attribute **1314**. For example one of the mask templates **1128** may have a full mask operator configured to cause the attribute **1314** to not be shown in the masked response **1148**.

(226) Referring now to FIG. **14**, the private information **1134**, the masked response **1148**, and masking operators **1404** of one of the mask templates **1128** are shown in greater detail, according to an exemplary embodiment. In FIG. **14**, there is a one to one mapping between the attributes of the private information **1134**, the attributes of the masked response **1148**, and the masking operators **1404**. In this regard, each of the masking operators **1404** (and each of the masking operators of each of the mask templates **1128**) is configured to handle (mask) a particular linked private information attribute of the private information **1134**.

(227) In FIG. **14**, the private information attribute “user_name” has a one to one correspondence to the masked attribute “Tho***.” In this regard, the “user_name” may be “Thomas” while the masked attribute is “Tho***.” The masking operating linked to the “user_name” and “Tho***” may be a masking operator configured to mask particular characters (e.g., the last three characters, the last four characters, the first two characters, etc.) with a “*” reference character. However, the reference character can be any character, e.g., “x,” “#,” “-,” etc.

(228) The attribute “address” of the private information **1134** can have a one to one correspondence to the masked attribute “123 N Ave.” As can be seen, the masked attribute “123 N Ave.” is shown in the clear, i.e., it is not masked. In this regard, a “shown in the clear” masking operator can be associated with the “address” attribute. Other types of masking operators can include encryption masking operators configured to perform a particular type of encryption (e.g., Rivest-Shamir-Adleman (RSA), Triple Data Encryption Algorithm (triple DES), Blowfish, Advanced Encryption Standard (AES), etc.). Another masking operator may be a masking operator configured to completely hide an attribute, i.e., not show the attribute. Furthermore, another masking operator may be configured to hide certain characters or values of an attribute, e.g., not show the first three digits of an attribute, not show the first two digits of an attribute, etc.

(229) Referring now to FIG. **15**, a diagram of access of a resource as a function of multiple access values is shown, according to an exemplary embodiment. In some embodiments, principle **1502** represents a particular accessing device, or requesting device, e.g., the client devices **548**, BMS controller **466**, etc. The access values may be the access values **1104**. FIG. **15** illustrates that the principle **1502** has access to resource **1504** based on a function multiple access values. This access as a function of multiple values can be implemented through the mask templates **1128** which can be selected as a function of the multiple access values.

(230) In some embodiments, the principle **1502** is a user device and the user device requests the resource **1504**, is given access to the resource as a function of the access values, and the user device presents the resource **1504** to a user to review on a screen of the user device. For example, if the resource **1504** is a social security number, the user device may receive the social security number based on a function of the access values associated with the user device.

(231) Referring now to FIG. **16**, the entity database **1124** of FIG. **11** is shown in greater detail including multiple entities related to each other, according to an exemplary embodiment. In FIG. **16**, the client devices **548** can generate queries (e.g., the information request **1146** and/or related information request **1645**) for the entity database **1124**. In some embodiments, the queries may be queries to the cloud entity service **626** which is configured to generate the masked response **1148** provided to the client devices **548** in response to the queries, the response generated by the masking engine **1118**.

(232) The client devices **548** can generate the related information request **1645**. The related information request **1645** can be a request for private information of one entity and private information of another entity linked to the one entity. For example, user entity **1608** (object entity) hasA **1638** (relational entity)

personal identifying information (PII) **1604** (data entity). Furthermore, user entity **1608** isRelatedTo **1662** (relational entity) user entity **1606** (object entity) and similarly, the relationship is transitive, user entity **1606** isRelatedTo **1662** user entity **1608**. Furthermore, user entity **1606** hasA **1630** (relational entity) personal identifying information (PII) **1619** (data entity). This relationship between user entity **1608** and user entity **1606** can be reflexive such that a request for PII **1604** of user entity **1608**, and information of entities related to user entity **1608** (e.g., PII **1619** of user entity **1606**) may require the same (or similar) permissions for a request for PII **1619** of user entity **1606** and information of entities related to user entity **1606** (e.g., PII **1604** of user entity **1608**). PII **1619** and PII **1604**, in addition to PII **1664**, can be the same and/or similar to the private information **1134**.

(233) In some embodiments, the relationships between entities of entity database **1124** (e.g., user entity **1608** and user entity **1606** via isRelatedTo **1662** and isRelatedTo **1660** (relational entity)) may have transitive closure. The transitive closure of a binary relation R on a set X is the smallest relation on X that contains R and is transitive. In this regard, the entity database **1124** can have transitive closure. In some embodiments, based on a given set of relations, the cloud entity service **626** can generate additional relations (or derive that there are additional relations). For example, if: a.fwdarw.b.fwdarw.c then the entity service **626** can be configured to generate (e.g., via Warshall's algorithm) additional relationships (the transitive closure) based on the relationship a.fwdarw.b.fwdarw.c such: a.fwdarw.b, b.fwdarw.c, a.fwdarw.c

(234) User entity **1608** hasA **1636** (relational entity) ACL **1614** (data entity). The ACL **1614** may be the same as and/or similar to ACL **1136** as described with reference to FIG. **11**.

(235) Furthermore, user entity **1606** hasA **1646** (relational entity) ACL **1644** (data entity). The ACL **1614** can define, e.g., can include a list of access values, what access values have access to private information of the user entity **1608**. Similarly, the ACL **1644** can define, e.g., can include a list of access values, what access values have access to private information of the user entity **1606**. In this regard, the masking engine **1118** (and/or the cloud entity service **626**) can determine whether a request for private information of user entity **1608** and information related to user entity **1608** (e.g., the user entity **1606**) should be granted in view of the access values and the ACL **1614** and the ACL **1644**.

(236) As an example, the ACL **1614** and the ACL **1644** may each store a list of roles as follows:

(237) TABLE-US-00006 TABLE 1 Access To User Entity 1608 ACL 1614 Super User Database
Administrator Guest User

(238) TABLE-US-00007 TABLE 2 Access To User Entity 1606 ACL 1644 Super User Database
Administrator Front Desk

(239) If the role identifier **1106** of client devices **548** is "Super User," the masking engine **1118** can determine, whether client devices **548** has access to PII **1604** of user entity **1608** and information related user entity **1608**, e.g., PII **1619** of user entity **1606**. In the current example, since the client devices **548** is a "Super User," the masking engine **1118** can determine, based on the ACL **1614** and the ACL **1644**, that the client devices **548** has access to both PII **1619** and PII **1604**. The client devices **548** can be configured to retrieve a mask related to each of the user entities **1608** and user entity **1606** (e.g., the mask templates **1618** (data entity), the mask template **1616** (data entity), and/or the mask templates **1602**) and mask the PII **1604** with a mask templated retrieved for the user entity **1608** and mask the PII **1619** with a mask retrieved for the user entity **1606**.

(240) As another example, if the role identifier **1106** of client devices **548** is "Guest User," the masking engine **1118** can determine, whether client devices **548** has access to PII **1604** of user entity **1608** and information related to PII **1619**. In the current example, since the client devices **548** is a "Guest User," the masking engine **1118** can determine, based on the ACL **1614** and the ACL **1644**, that the client devices **548** has access to PII **1604** but not to PII **1619**. The masking engine **1118** can be configured to retrieve a mask related of the user entities **1608** but not the user entity **1606** and mask the PII **1604** with a mask templated retrieved for the user entity **1608**.

(241) In some embodiments, the masked results are joined together to be provided to the client devices **548**. In some embodiments, the masking engine **1118** can be configured to automatically determine whether client devices **548** has access to information related to user entity **1608** in response to receiving the information request **1146** and can be configured to join the masked information of the user entity **1608** and the user entity **1606** together into the masked response **1148**. In some embodiments, the masking engine **1118** can be configured to determine and join related information only if the original request is a

request for related information, e.g., the related information request **1645**.

(242) User entity **1608** hasA **1622** (relational entity) mask templates **1618** and hasA **1624** (relational entity) mask template **1616**. Furthermore, user entity **1606** hasA **1628** (relational entity) mask templates **1620** (data entity) and hasA **1626** (relational entity) the mask template **1616**. This illustrates that multiple user entities can have their own mask templates and/or can share (both be linked to) a common one or multiple mask templates. In this regard, the masking engine **1118** can be configured, based on the relationships of the entity database **1124**, to retrieve and mask private information for multiple entities with the same mask or with different masks. In some embodiments, certain types of object entities are linked to specific sets of mask templates. For example, all thermostat object entities may be linked to a set of thermostat specific mask templates while all building occupants are linked to a set of building occupant mask templates.

(243) FIG. **16** includes an account attribute **1610** (data entity). The user entity **1608**, the user entity **1606**, and a building site entity **1612** (object entity) can each be linked to the account attribute **1610**, i.e., user entity **1608** hasA **1634** (relational entity) account attribute **1610**, user entity **1606** hasA **1632** (relational entity) account attribute **1610**, and the building site entity **1612** hasA **1656** (relational entity) account attribute **1610**. Furthermore, user entity **1606** isRelatedTo **1617** (relational entity) building site entity **1612**. Building site entity **1612** is another example of an object entity and may have its own PII **1664** (data entity), i.e., building site entity **1612** hasA **1658** (relational entity) PII **1664**. The building site entity **1612** also has its own mask templates **1648** (data entity), i.e., building site entity **1612** hasA **1650** (relational entity) mask templates **1648**. The building site entity **1612** hasA **1652** (relational entity) ACL **1654** (data entity).

(244) In some embodiments, if the client devices **548** requests the account attribute **1610**, the masking engine **1118** can be configured to determine, based on the object entities linked to the account attribute **1610** and ACLs for each of the object entities, whether the client devices **548** is associated with a principle included in each of the ACLs. Furthermore, in some embodiments, the masking engine **1118** can mask the account attribute **1610** with multiple retrieved masks in response to a determination that the client devices **548** has access to the account attribute **1610**. For example, the masking engine **1118** can retrieve a mask template for user entity **1608**, a mask template for user entity **1606**, and a mask template for building site entity **1612**. The highest level of security of each masking operator of the retrieved mask templates can be applied on the account attribute **1610**.

(245) For example, if one mask template has a show in clear operator and another mask template has a do not show operator for the same attribute of account attribute **1610**, the masking engine **1118** can mask the account attribute with the do not show operator since that masking operator is the highest level of security. Furthermore, if, for another attribute of account attribute **1610**, there is a show in clear operator, a mask first character operator, and a mask first two characters operators, the masking operator can be configured to mask the attribute with the first two characters operator.

(246) In some embodiments, the building site entity **1612** represents a particular building (e.g., the school **110**, the hospital **120**, the factory **130**, and/or the office **140** as described with reference to FIG. **1**.) The PII **1664** may be building information such as an address, a building security access code, a building temperature, etc. The user entity **1608** isRelatedTo **1640** (relational entity) the building site entity **1612**.

(247) Referring now to FIG. **17**, a process **1700** for masking private information with mask templates is shown, according to an exemplary embodiment. The cloud entity service **626** is configured to perform the process **1700** in some embodiments. More specifically, the masking engine **1118**, the external interface **1102**, the hash manager **1114**, and/or the entity database **1124** are configured to perform the process **1700** in some embodiments. Furthermore, any computing device as described herein can be configured to perform the process **1700**.

(248) In step **1702**, the external interface **1102** receives the information request **1146** (and/or the related information request **1645**), the information request **1146** being a request for the private information **1134** of the entity **1126** linked to the entity **1126**. The information request **1146** may indicate specific information of the private information **1134**, e.g., specifically indicate the private information **1134**, or may indicate the entity **1126** and a request for any stored private information linked to the entity **1126**.

(249) In some embodiments, the external interface **1102** provides the information request **1146** to the masking engine **1118**. Based on the information request **1146**, the masking engine **1118** can determine whether the information request **1146** is a request for the private information **1134** or a request for public

information. If the request is for public information, the masking engine **1118** can be configured to provide the public information to the client devices **548** without masking, if the request is for the private information **1134**, the masking engine **1118** can perform the steps **1704-1712** of the process **1700**.

(250) In the step **1704**, the hash manager **1114** can generate the access hash key **1116** based on the access values **1104**. The access values **1104** may be values received from the client devices **548** or retrieved for the client devices **548** (e.g., retrieved by the external interface **1102** based on login credentials of the client devices **548**). In some embodiments, the hash manager **1114** can concatenate multiple access values together and hash the resulting concatenation of access values to generate the access hash key **1116**. In some embodiments, the step **1704** is an optional step, thus the step **1704** is shown in dashed lines in FIG. **17**.

(251) In the step **1706**, the masking engine **1118** can select one of the mask templates **1128**. The masking engine **1118** can select the one of the mask templates **1128** based on the access values **1104** and/or based on the access hash key **1116**. In some embodiments, each of the mask templates **1128** stores or is associated with, a particular combination of values of the access values **1104** and/or the access hash key **1116**. In this regard, the masking engine **1118** can perform a search of the mask templates **1128** with the access values **1104** and/or the access hash key **1116** to identify the mask template associated with the particular access values **1104** and/or the particular access hash key **1116**. In some embodiments, the masking engine **1118** can store and/or operate based on a mask retrieval structure which may link particular values of the access values **1104** and/or the access hash key **1116** to specific mask templates of the mask templates **1128**.

(252) The masking engine **1118** can determine which mask templates to select from based on relational links between the entity for which information is requested and the mask templates to select from. For example, in FIG. **16**, user entity **1608** can be linked to mask templates **1618** and mask template **1616** while building site entity **1612** can be linked to mask templates **1648**. In this regard, a request for private information of the user entity **1608** may result in a mask selection from the mask templates **1618** and mask template **1616** while a request for private information of the building site entity **1612** may result in a selection of a mask template of the mask templates **1648**.

(253) In the step **1708**, the masking engine **1118** can be configured to retrieve the private information **1134** from a private information storage database. In some embodiments, the private information **1134** is stored directly in the entity database **1124**. In some embodiments, the private information **1134** is stored encrypted in encrypted data storage **1122**. In this regard, the masking engine **1118** can query either or both of the entity database **1124** and the encrypted data storage **1122** for the private information **1134**.

(254) In step **1710**, the masking engine **1118** can mask the private information **1134** based on the selected mask of the step **1706**. In some embodiments, the private information **1134** includes one or multiple attributes. Each of the attributes of the private information **1134** may have a one to one mapping with masking operators of the selected mask template of the step **1706**. This is further described with reference to FIG. **14**. In the step **1712**, the resulting masked private information can be provided by the masking engine **1118** to the external interface **1102** which can in turn provide the masked response **1148**, a message that is or includes the masked data structure determined in the step **1715**, to the client devices **548**.

(255) Referring now to FIG. **18**, a process **1800** for masking private information of two different linked entities with mask templates is shown, according to an exemplary embodiment. The cloud entity service **626** is configured to perform the process **1800** in some embodiments. More specifically, the masking engine **1118**, the external interface **1102**, the hash manager **1114**, and/or the entity database **1124** are configured to perform the process **1800** in some embodiments. Furthermore, any computing device as described herein can be configured to perform the process **1800**.

(256) In step **1802**, the external interface **1102** can receive one or more access values **1104** and a request for first private information for a first entity of the entity database **1124** and related second private information of a second entity of the entity database **1124** linked by the entity database **1124** to the first entity (and/or vice versa, the first entity linked to the second entity). For example, the external interface **1102** and/or the masking engine **1118** can receive an information request for private information of the user entity **1608** and the user entity **1606**. However, the information request may not necessarily be for the user entity **1608** and the user entity **1606** and can be for any type of entity or building related entity (e.g., a building site entity, a building device entity, etc.) The entity database **1124** can link the user entity **1608** to the user entity **1606** and the user entity **1606** to the user entity **1608** via the relational entities `isRelatedTo`

1662 and **RelatedTo 1660**. The information request may be the related information request **1645** and can indicate that the client devices **548** is querying the system for private information of the user entity **1608** and private information of other entities related to the user entity **1608** (or specifically to private information of user entity **1608** and private information of user entity **1606**).

(257) In step **1804**, the masking engine **1118** can determine, based on the one or more access values **1104** and one or more ACLs linked to the first entity or the second entity, whether the user devices **584** has access to both the first private information of the first entity and the second private information of the second entity linked to the first entity. For example, based on the access values **1104**, the masking engine **1118** and one or multiple ACLs, e.g., the ACLs linked to the user entity **1608** and the user entity **1606** (e.g., the ACL **1614** and the ACL **1644**) whether the client devices **548** have access to both the user entity **1608** and the user entity **1606**. In response to a determination that the client devices **548** has access to both the user entity **1608** and the user entity **1606**, the masking engine **1118** can mask and provide private information for both entities to the client devices **548**. If the masking engine **1118** determines, based on the access values **1104** and the ACLs, that the client devices **548** has access to both the user entity **1608** and the user entity **1606**.

(258) In step **1806**, the masking engine **1118** can retrieve a first mask template for the first entity and a second mask template for the second entity from the entity database **1124** based on the one or more access values **1104** in response to a determination that user devices **548** has access to the second private information of the second entity linked to the first entity and the first private information. For example, the masking engine **1118** can be configured to retrieve a mask template for the user entity **1608** and a mask template for the user entity **1606**. In some embodiments, the masking engine **1118** can perform the step **1806** in response to a determination that the client devices **548** has access to the private information of the user entity **1608** and the user entity **1606** as determined in the step **1804**. In some embodiments, the masking engine **1118** can select the mask template for the user entity **1608** from the mask templates **1618** and the mask template **1616** while the masking engine **1118** can select the mask template for the user entity **1606** from the mask templates **1620** and the mask template **1616**. The selections of mask templates can be made via the access values **1104** and/or the access hash key **1116**. For example, via a lookup table and/or via a search, the masking engine **1118** can determine the mask templates that are associated with the particular values of the access values **1104** and/or the access hash key **1116**.

(259) In some embodiments, to perform the selection of a mask template for an entity, the masking engine **1118** can determine a set of mask templates linked to the entity via the entity database **1124**. For example, the masking engine **1118** could for the building site entity **1612**, determine that the building site entity **1612** is linked to the mask templates **1648** via the relational entity, hasA **1650**. In this regard, the masking engine **1118** would select a mask template of the mask templates **1648** since the building site entity **1612** is linked to the mask templates **1648** but would not select one of the mask templates **1620** linked to the user entity **1606** since the mask templates **1620** are not linked to the building site entity **1612**.

(260) In step **1808**, the masking engine **1118** can retrieve the first private information from a private information database for the first entity and retrieve the second private information from the private information database for the second entity. For example, the masking engine **1118** can retrieve the PII **1604** for the user entity **1608**, based on the relational entity hasA **1638**, and retrieve the PII **1619**, based on the relational entity hasA **1630**. In some embodiments, the private information database is the entity database **1124**, and in this regard, the masking engine **1118** can retrieve the private information from the entity database **1124**. In some embodiments, the private information database is the encrypted data storage **1122** and in this regard, the private information can be retrieved from the encrypted data storage **1122**.

(261) In step **1810**, the masking engine **1118** can mask the first private information with the first mask template retrieved in the step **1806** and mask the second private information with the second mask template retrieved in the step **1806**. For example, the masking engine **1118** can mask the first private information with the first mask template and mask the second private information with the second mask template. For example, the masking engine **1118** can mask the PII **1604** for the user entity **1608** with the mask template selected from the mask templates **1618** and the mask template **1616**. Furthermore, the masking engine **1118** can mask the PII **1619** for the user entity **1606** with the mask template selected from the mask templates **1620** and the mask template **1616**.

(262) In step **1812**, the masking engine **1118** can provide the first masked private information and the second masked private information to the user devices **548** in response to the determination that the user

devices **548** has access to private information of the second entity linked to the first entity and the first private information. For example, the masking engine **1118** can provide the masked first private information and the masked second private information to the client devices **548** via the external interface **1102**. In some embodiments, the masking engine **1118** provides the masked response **1148** to the external interface **1102**, the masked response including the first private information and the second private information. In some embodiments, the masking engine **1118** may only provide the first masked private information and the second masked private information in response to the determination that the client devices **548** has access to both the private information of the first entity and the private information of the second entity as determined in the step **1804**.

(263) Entity Database with Transitive Closure

(264) Referring now to FIG. **19A**, the entity database **1124** and the entity service **626** is shown where the entity service **626** determines a transitive closure for the entities of the entity database **1124**, according to an exemplary embodiment. Entity database **1124** includes a first entity **1902**, a second entity **1904**, a third entity **1906**, a fourth entity **1908**, and a fifth entity **1910**, in some embodiments. The entity database **1124** can include any number of entities and can determine a transitive closure for any number of entities and any relations between the entities (e.g., as defined by relational entities). The entities **1902-1910** can be an object entity, a class entity, a data entity and can represent people, places, buildings, devices, and/or any other device, system, building, or person as described herein.

(265) The entity service **626**, for a set of entities (e.g., the entities **1902-1910**) and a set of relations between the entities of the entity database **1124** (e.g., the relations shown in solid lines), is configured to determine a transitive closure for the entity database **1124** in some embodiments. Furthermore, based on the transitive closure, the cloud entity service **626** can add additional relations between the entities (e.g., the relations shown in dashed lines). The transitive closure of a binary relation R on a set X is the smallest relation on X that contains R and is transitive. Given a set X , e.g., entities **1902-1910**, and relationships between the entities R (e.g., relational entities), the cloud entity service **626** can determine a transitive closure T . The cloud entity service **626** can use any kind of transitive closure calculation algorithm, for example, the Floyd Warshall Algorithm.

(266) Representing each of the entities **1902-1910** as 1, 2, 3, 4, and 5 respectively, and a relation between entities as (x, y) , let: $X=\{1, 2, 3, 4, 5\}$ $R=\{(1, 2), (2, 3), (3, 4), (4, 5)\}$ then the transitive closure T , that the cloud entity service **626** can be configured to determine is: $T=\{(1, 2), (2, 3), (3, 4), (4, 5), (1, 3), (1, 4), (1, 5), (2, 4), (2, 5), (3, 5)\}$

(267) By determining a transitive closure for the entity database **1124**, direct links between entities can be determined. By resolving the direct links, a database operator can easily see the direct relations between entities and can understand which entities may be linked to different types of information.

(268) For example, the access that different object entities have to certain private information may be defined based on a direct link between the object entity and the private information. For example, if the real-world system represented by the object entity queries the entity database **1124** for the private information, the cloud entity service **626** can determine that that real-world system has access to the private information based on the direct link. If the first entity **1902** is a thermostat and the fifth entity **1910** is timeseries data that the thermostat operates based on, without the transitive closure (the dashed lines) a database manager setting up the entity database **1124**, and/or the cloud entity service **626**, may not discern that the first entity **1902** is linked to the fifth entity **1910** since no direct link is shown, only indirect links through entities **1904-1908**. However, once the transitive closure is determined for the entity database **1124**, the direct link, i.e., the link $(1, 5)$ between the first entity **1902** and the fifth entity **1910** is available and can be added by the cloud entity service **626** as a link to the entity database **1124**. The determination of a transitive closure and the addition of links to the entity database **1124** based on the transitive closure can implement dynamic inheritance.

(269) The graphical representation of entities shown in FIG. **19A**, and furthermore in FIG. **19B**, FIG. **11**, FIGS. **20-21**, FIGS. **23-24**, and FIGS. **26-27** can be visually displayed to a database manager via a display screen of a user device, the client devices **548**. In this regard, the database manager may provide input (e.g., new entities, new relationships between entities, construction of the database, etc.) to the cloud entity service **626**. In response to new data, in response to a period occurring (e.g., an hourly period, a daily period, a weekly period, a monthly period), in response to a transitive closure calculation command from the client devices **548**, and/or a query to entity database **1124** for information, the cloud entity service **626**

can determine the transitive closure for the entity database **1124** and add new relations based on the transitive closure (e.g., the relations of the transitive closure not included in the original set of relations of the entity database **1124**) to the entity database **1124**.

(270) By allowing a database manager to edit the entity database **1124** and then determining the transitive closure and adding additional relations to the entity database **1124** for user review, the database manager can understand all links, particularly direct links. Since the direct links may identify which entities have access to what data, this can help a database manager understand what systems will be able to access what information.

(271) Referring now to FIG. **19B**, the entity database **1124** is shown storing facial data associated with particular users which are linked to access control systems for a building, according to an exemplary embodiment. Assuming that the graphical representation of the entity database **1124** of FIG. **19B** is provided to a database manager, the database manager (or the system can automatically define) that user entity **1912** (object entity) hasA **1914** (relational entity) facial data **1916** (data entity). The facial data **1916** may be the image of a face or data pertaining to the face of a user represented by the user entity **1912**. Similarly, user entity **1918** (object entity) hasA **1920** (relational entity) facial data **1922** (data entity).

(272) The building may have two different entrances, a first entrance and a second entrance. A first security system (e.g., a system including multiple cameras, gates, alarms, sensors, image processing systems, etc.) may be installed at the first entrance for performing access control to the building at the first entrance. A second security system may be installed at a second entrance for performing access control to the building at the second entrance. The first security system and the second security system can be the same and/or similar to the security building subsystem **538** as described with reference to FIG. **5**. A database manager can define the first security system and the second security system as a first entrance access system **1924** (object entity) and a second entrance access system **1926** (object entity).

(273) Furthermore, the database manager can define that the first entrance access system **1924** allowsAccessTo **1928** (relational entity) the user entity **1912** and allowsAccessTo **1930** (relational entity), the user entity **1918**. Furthermore, the database manager may determine that since the second security system and the first security system guard the same building, that the second entrance access system **1926** isRelatedTo **1932** (relational entity) the first entrance access system **1924**.

(274) In some embodiments, the first security system and the second security system includes cameras that capture images of the faces of the users represented by the user entity **1912** and the user entity **1918** and determines whether to grant these users access based on the facial data **1916** and the facial data **1922**. In the entity database **1124**, access to the facial data **1916** and the facial data **1922** may be defined based on relational entities. Ignoring the relations shown in dashed lines, only the user entity **1912** and the user entity **1918** may have access to the facial data **1916** and the facial data **1922**, therefore, only a masking request by either the user entity **1912** or the user entity **1918** will result in the delivery and/or masking of the facial data **1916** and the facial data **1922** respectively.

(275) However, if the cloud entity service **626** determines a transitive closure for the entity database **1124** (e.g., automatically or per request by the database manager via the client devices **548**) additional relations between the entities of the entity database **1124** can be generated establishing that the second entrance access system **1926** and the first entrance access system **1924** also have access to the facial data **1916** and the facial data **1922** (the relations shown in dashed lines). The new relations that the cloud entity service **626** can be configured to add to the entity database **1124** based on the determination of the transitive closure may be the relational entities, hasA **1934**, hasA **1936**, allowsAccessTo **1938**, hasA **1940**, hasA **1942**, and allowsAccessTo **1944**. These relations implement a dynamic inheritance that can continuously be updated and/or modified as new entities or relations are added to the entity database **1124** via the determination of a transitive closure.

(276) Referring now to FIGS. **20** and **21**, the entity database **1124** is shown where a determination of a transitive closure for the entity database **1124** for a new object entity being added to the entity database **1124** is performed, according to an exemplary embodiment. The cloud entity service **626** is shown to receive a new entity for addition to the entity database **1124**, the new entity being linked to an existing object entity **2002** of the entity database **1124**. In some embodiments, the indication to add the new entity and the link to be established between the new entity and the existing entity may be generated by a database manager via the client devices **548**. In response to the request, the cloud entity service **626** can cause the entity database **1124** to add a new object entity **2006** and a relational entity, hasA **2012**, to mask

templates **2008** (data entity) for the new object entity **2006**. Since the request indicated the relation between the new entity and the existing entity, the cloud entity service **626** can cause the new object entity **2006** to be linked to the existing object entity **2002** via the relational entity, **isRelatedTo 2014**.

(277) In response to adding the new object entity **2006**, the mask templates **2008**, and the relational entities **hasA 2012** and **isRelatedTo 2014**, the cloud entity service **626** can determine a transitive closure for the entity database **1124** and add an additional link between the new object entity **2006** and PII **2004** based on the transitive closure. In this regard, both the existing object entity **2002** and the new object entity **2006** are linked to the PII **2004** via relational entities **hasA 2010** and **hasA 2016**.

(278) Since the new object entity **2006** and the existing object entity **2002** are linked to the PII **2004**, a request for private information for the existing object entity **2002** may cause the PII **2004** to be retrieved and masked. Furthermore, a request for private information of the new object entity **2006** may cause the PII **2004** to be retrieved (the private information identified via the relational entity **hasA 2016** added based on the determination of the transitive closure) and masked via a selected mask template of the mask templates **2008**.

(279) Referring now to FIG. **22**, a process **2200** for adding a new entity to the entity database **1124** and determining a transitive closure to update the entity database **1124** is shown, according to an exemplary embodiment. The cloud entity service **626** is configured to perform the process **2200** in some embodiments. Furthermore, the masking engine **1118**, the external interface **1102**, the hash manager **1114**, and/or the entity database **1124** are configured to perform the process **2200** in some embodiments. Any computing device as described herein can be configured to perform the process **2200**.

(280) In step **2202**, the cloud entity service **626** receives an indication to add a new entity to the entity database **1124**, the new entity linked to an existing entity of the entity database and to one or more mask templates, the existing entity linked to private information. For example, the cloud entity service **626** can receive an indication to add the new object entity **2006** and link the new object entity **2006** to the existing object entity **2002**. The existing object entity **2002** is linked to the PII **2004**.

(281) In step **2204**, the cloud entity service **626** adds the new entity to the entity database **1124**, adds the new mask templates to the entity database **1124**, adds a relational link between the new entity and the existing entity, and adds a relational link between the new entity and the mask templates. For example, the cloud entity service **626** can cause the entity database **1124** to add the new object entity **2006**, a relational entity **isRelatedTo 2014** which links the new object entity **2006** to the existing object entity **2002**. Furthermore, the cloud entity service **626** can cause the entity database **1124** to add the mask templates **2008** to the entity database **1124** and the relational entity **hasA 2012** linking the new object entity **2006** to the mask templates **2008**.

(282) In step **2206**, the cloud entity service **626** can determine a transitive closure for the entity database **1124** in response to the additions to the entity database **1124**. For example, the cloud entity service **626** can identify all of the entities of the entity database **1124** and which of the entities represent relations between entities. Based on the links and the entities, the cloud entity service **626** can determine the transitive closure for the entity database **1124** which may be indicative of additional direct links between entities (e.g., links via relational entities) that did not previously exist in the entity database **1124**.

(283) In step **2208**, the cloud entity service **626** can add new relational links based on the transitive closure to the entity database, specifically, a relational link between the new entity and the private information. For example, the cloud entity service **626** can add the relational entity **hasA 2016** to the entity database **1124**. The cloud entity service **626** can determine which direct links are missing from the entity database **1124** based on the transitive closure and add any missing links, in this instance, the relational entity **hasA 2016** linking the new object entity **2006** to the PII **2004**.

(284) Since the new relational link has been added to the entity database **1124** between the new entity and the private information, a request for the private information for the new entity may result in the retrieval of the private information now linked to the new entity and masking via a selection of one of the new masks linked to the new entity. The steps **2210-2216** describe this masking can be the same as and/or similar to the steps of the process **1700** as described with reference to FIG. **17**.

(285) Referring now to FIGS. **23-24**, the entity database **1124** is shown where a determination of a transitive closure for the entity database **1124** for new PII being added to the entity database **1124** is performed, according to an exemplary embodiment. Cloud entity service **626** can receive an indication to add new private information to the entity database **1124** and to link the new private information to a

second entity of the entity database **1124**. For example, the indication may be received from a database manager from one of the client devices **548** and/or from any other system. The cloud entity service **626**, in response to receiving the indication, can cause the entity database **1124** to be updated to include new PII **2308** (object entity) and a relational entity hasA **2310** linking the second entity **2306** to the new PII **2308**. (286) In response to adding the new PII **2308** and the hasA **2310** to the entity database **1124**, the cloud entity service **626** can determine a transitive closure for the entity database **1124**. The transitive closure can indicate a relationship that does not exist in the entity database **1124**, e.g., a link, between a first entity **2304** (object entity), which hasA **2312** (relational entity) mask templates **2302** (data entities) and isRelatedTo **2314** (relational entity) the second entity **2306**, to the new PII **2308**. In this regard, based on the transitive closure, the cloud entity service **626** can identify a direct link that does not currently existing in the entity database **1124** that should exist based on the current links in the entity database **1124**. In this instance, the direct link is the link between the first entity **2304** and the new PII **2308** and the cloud entity service **626** can add the relational hasA **2316** to represent the link between the first entity **2304** and the new PII **2308**.

(287) Based on the new link between the first entity **2304** and the new PII **2316**, a query for private information of the first entity **2304** and/or the second entity **2306** can result in the retrieval and masking of the new PII **2308**. For the first entity **2304**, if a request is received for private information of the first entity **2304**, the cloud entity service **626** can determine that the new PII **2308** is private information of the first entity **2304** based on the relational entity hasA **2316** and can retrieve the new PII **2308** and mask the new PII **2308** with one of the mask templates **2302** linked to the first entity **2304** via the relational entity hasA **2312**.

(288) Referring now to FIG. **25**, a process **2500** for adding new PII to the entity database **1124** and determining a transitive closure to update the entity database **1124** is shown, according to an exemplary embodiment. The cloud entity service **626** is configured to perform the process **2500** in some embodiments. Furthermore, the masking engine **1118**, the external interface **1102**, the hash manager **1114**, and/or the entity database **1124** are configured to perform the process **2500** in some embodiments. Any computing device as described herein can be configured to perform the process **2500**.

(289) In step **2502**, the cloud entity service **626** can receive an indication to add new private information to the entity database **1124** and a link from a second entity of the entity database **1124** to the private information where a first entity of the entity database **1124** is linked to the second entity. For example, the request may be a request by another system or device as discussed herein, e.g., a request by a database manager of client devices **548**. The request may be a request to add the new PII **2308** to the entity database **1124** and a link between the second entity **2306** and the new PII **2308**, the relational entity hasA **2310**.

(290) In step **2504**, the cloud entity service **626** can add the new private information to the entity database **1124** and add a relational link between the second entity and the new private information. For example, the cloud entity service **626** can cause the new PII **2308** to be added to the entity database **1124** and can cause the relational entity hasA **2310** to be added to the entity database **1124**.

(291) In step **2506**, the cloud entity service **626** can determine a transitive closure for the entity database **1124** in response to adding the additions to the entity database **1124**. The transitive closure may indicate direct links which do not currently exist in the entity database **1124**. In this regard, in step **2508**, the cloud entity service **626** can add new relational links to the entity database **1124** not currently in the entity database **1124** based on the transitive closure. In this example, the cloud entity service **626** can add a new relational link to the entity database between the first entity and the new private information based on the transitive closure determined in the step **2506**. In this example, the new relational link is the relational entity hasA **2316** linking the first entity **2304** to the new PII **2308**.

(292) In steps **2510-2516**, a request for private information of the first entity can be received by the cloud entity service **626** from a requesting device. The cloud entity service can retrieve the new private information for the first entity based on the new relational link between the first entity and the private entity and select one of the one or more mask templates linked to the first entity, generate a masked response based on the retrieved private information and the selected mask template, and provide the masked response to the requesting device. The steps **2510-2516** may be the same and/or similar to the steps **1702-1712** as described with reference to FIG. **17** in the process **1700**.

(293) Referring now to FIGS. **26-27**, the entity database **1124** is shown where a determination of a transitive closure for the entity database **1124** for new mask templates being added to the entity database

1124 is performed, according to an exemplary embodiment. The cloud entity service **626** can be configured to receive an indication to add new mask templates and link the new mask templates to a second entity of the entity database **626**, second entity **2604** (object entity). The request may be received from a database manager via the user devices **536**.

(294) In response to the indication, the cloud entity service **626** be configured to add the mask templates **2616** (object entity) and a relational entity (hasA **2614**) linking the second entity **2604** to the mask templates **2616**. A first entity **2602** (object entity) of the entity database **1124** isRelatedTo **2608** (relational entity) the second entity **2604**. Furthermore, the first entity **2602** and the second entity **2604** are both linked to the PII **2612**. The first entity **2602** is linked to the PII **2606** via the relational entity hasA **2610** while the second entity **2604** is linked to the PII **2606** via the relational entity hasA **2612**.

(295) The cloud entity service **626** can determine a transitive closure for the entity database **1124**. In some embodiments, the cloud entity service **626** determines the transitive closure of the entity database **1124** in response to adding the mask templates **2616**, based on a user request, and/or at a particular time interval. The cloud entity service **626** can be configured to determine, from the transitive closure, that the entity database **1124** does not include a direct link, i.e., the direct link between the first entity **2602** and the mask templates **2616**. In this regard, the cloud entity service **626** can add a link between the first entity **2602** and the mask templates **2616**, a relational entity hasA **2618**.

(296) In FIG. **27**, both the first entity **2602** and the second entity **2604** share the same mask templates **2616** as determined by cloud entity service **626** based on the transitive closure. In this regard, a request for private information of the first entity **2602** or a request for private information of the second entity **2604** (e.g., the PII **2606**) can result in a selection of one of the mask templates of the mask templates **2616** as determine by the relational entities hasA **2614** and hasA **2618**.

(297) Referring now to FIG. **28**, a process **2800** for adding new mask templates to the entity database **1124** and determining a transitive closure to update the entity database **1124** is shown, according to an exemplary embodiment. The cloud entity service **626** is configured to perform the process **2500** in some embodiments. Furthermore, the masking engine **1118**, the external interface **1102**, the hash manager **1114**, and/or the entity database **1124** are configured to perform the process **2800** in some embodiments. Any computing device as described herein can be configured to perform the process **2800**.

(298) In step **2802**, the cloud entity service **626** can receive an indication to add new mask templates to the entity database **1124** and to link a second entity of the entity database **1124** to the new mask templates. For example, the cloud entity service **626** can receive a request to add the new mask templates and to link the second entity to the new mask templates from a database manager via the client devices **548**. Furthermore, the request may be to add the mask templates **2616** to the entity database **1124** and the relational entity hasA **2614**.

(299) In step **2804**, based on the receive indication, the cloud entity service **626** can add the new mask templates to the entity database **1124** and link the second entity to the new mask templates. For example, the cloud entity service **626** can add the mask templates **2616** to the entity database **1124** and the relational entity hasA **2614**.

(300) In step **2806**, the cloud entity service **626** can mask private information of the second entity based on the new mask templates and the relational link between the second entity and the mask templates. For example, if the cloud entity service **626** receives a query for the private information of the second entity **2604** (e.g., the PII **2606**), the cloud entity service **626** can determine that the cloud entity service **626** should select a mask from the mask templates **2616** based on the link between the second entity **2604** and the mask templates **2616**, hasA **2614**.

(301) In step **2808**, the cloud entity service **626** can determine a transitive closure for the entity database **1124** in response to the additions to the entity database **1124**. The transitive closure may indicate that there are relations between the entities of the entity database **1124** that are not currently reflected in the entity database **1124**. For example, the cloud entity service **626** can compare the relations of the entity database **1124** and determine that the transitive closure includes additional relations than the relations that are currently in the entity database **1124**.

(302) In step **2810**, based on the transitive, the cloud entity service **626** can add additional links between the entities of the entity database, in this example, the cloud entity service **626** can add another relational link between a first entity of the entity database **1124** to the new mask templates. For example, the cloud entity service **626** can determine that the transitive closure indicates a relationship between the first entity

2602 and the mask templates **2616** which does not currently exist in the entity database **1124**. In this regard, the cloud entity service **626** can add the relational entity **hasA 2618** linking the first entity **2602** to the mask templates **2616**.

(303) In step **2812**, the cloud entity service **626** can mask private information of the first entity based on the new mask templates and the relational link between the first entity and the mask templates. For example, since the first entity has been linked to the new mask templates via the transitive closure update, the entity service **626** can select a mask of the new mask templates for masking private information of the first entity. For example, the first entity **2602** hasA **2610 PII 2606** and hasA **2618** mask templates **2616**, the relational entity **2618** being added based on the update to the entity database **1124** performed based on the transitive closure. In response to a query for the private information of the first entity **2602**, the cloud entity service **626** can retrieve a mask of the mask templates **2616** and mask the PII **2606** based on the retrieved mask.

(304) Physical Transport of Mask Templates Across Systems

(305) Referring now to FIG. **29**, the cloud entity service **626** and the encrypted data storage **1122** are shown as separate systems communicating via the network **546**. A requesting device **2902** can be a device that generates a query for private information, the information request **1146** and communicates the information request **1146** to the encrypted data storage **1122** via the network **546**. The request device **2902** can be any kind of system, for example, the building management platform **102**, the weather service **152**, the news service **154**, the document service **156**, the media service **158**, the BMS controller **266**, the client devices **548**, etc. With respect of FIG. **29**, a mask template is transported from the cloud entity service **626** to the encrypted data storage **1122**. However, a mask can be transported to any kind of system or device (e.g., database, BMS, thermostat, controller, web server, social media platform, user device, smartphone, etc.)

(306) The encrypted data storage **1122** can be configured to store private information **2906**, for example, the private information **1134** and/or any of the PII as described herein. The encrypted data storage **1122** can be configured to retrieve a mask template for the private information **2906** and mask the private information **2906** with the masking engine **1118**. The result of the masking may be the masked response **1148**. The encrypted data storage **1122** can communicate the masked response **1148** to the requesting device **2902** via the network **546**.

(307) To retrieve the mask for masking the private information **2906**, the encrypted data storage **1122** can communicate a mask request **2908** for the private information **2906** to the cloud entity service **626** via the network **546**. The external interface **1102** can determine, based on the mask request **2908** and the entity database **1124**, which mask to retrieve and communicate to the encrypted data storage **1222**, i.e., the retrieved mask **2904**. In some embodiments, the encrypted data storage **1122** can determine and communicate the hash key **1116** based on the access values **1104** to the cloud entity service **626** via the network **546** for the mask retriever **1138** to retrieve the mask from the mask templates **1128**.

(308) In some embodiments, the encrypted data storage **1122** can determine and/or receive the access values **1104** and communicate the access values **1104** to the mask retriever **1138** for mask selection. The encrypted data storage **1122** can receive login credentials from the requesting device **2902** and identify the access values **1104** based on the login credentials or can receive the access values **1104** or an indication of the access values **1104**, for example, can receive an IP address of the requesting device **2902**. In some embodiments, the cloud entity service **626** can determine the access hash key **1116** and/or the access values **1104** based on the mask request **2908**, for example, the mask request **2908** may include credentials of the requesting device **2902** linked to particular access values **1104** stored by the cloud entity service **626**.

(309) Referring now to FIG. **30**, a process **3000** for transporting a mask template to another system is shown, according to an exemplary embodiment. The cloud entity service **626**, the encrypted data storage **1122**, and/or the requesting device **2902** are configured to perform the process **3000** in some embodiments. Furthermore, the masking engine **1118**, the external interface **1102**, the hash manager **1114**, and/or the entity database **1124** are configured to perform the process **3000** in some embodiments. Any computing device as described herein can be configured to perform the process **3000**.

(310) In step **3002**, a first system can receive a request for a mask template for an entity of an entity database from a second system via a network. For example, the cloud entity service **626** can receive the mask request **2908** from the encrypted data storage **1122** via the network **546**. The request may include an

indication of the access values **1104**, the access hash key **1116**, login credentials, IP addresses, etc. and may indicate which entity of the entity database **1124** the mask template request is for.

(311) In step **3004**, the first system can select the mask template from one or more mask templates linked to the entity via the entity database. For example, based on the indication of the access values **1104**, the access hash key **1116**, the login credentials, and/or the indication of the entity, the mask retriever **1138** can retrieve a mask from the mask templates **1128**. In step **3006**, the first system can send the mask template to the second system via the network **546**, e.g., the cloud entity service **626** can send the retrieved mask **2904** to the encrypted data storage **1122** via the network **546**.

(312) In step **3008**, the second system can retrieve private information for the entity. For example, the encrypted data storage **1122** can retrieve the private information **2906**. In some embodiments, the private information **2906** is stored by the encrypted data storage **1122** and the masking engine **1118** can retrieve the private information **2906** stored by the encrypted data storage **1122**. In some embodiments, the encrypted data storage **1122** communicates to another system that stores the private information **2906** and retrieves the private information **2906** from that system. In step **3010**, based on the mask template, the second system can mask the private information with the mask template. For example, the masking engine **1118** can mask the private information **2906** based on the retrieved mask **2904**. Masking the private information **2906** may be the same and/or similar to the masking as described with reference to FIGS. **11-18**.

(313) Security Equipment Operation, Environmental Building Control, and User Interfaces Via Mask Templates

(314) Referring generally to FIGS. **11-30**, various implementations of the masking of private information via mask templates of an entity database can be implemented to mask attribute level information. One implementation of the masking of private information may be in an HVAC system. For the HVAC system, the BMS controller **466** that operates to control physical building conditions (e.g., temperature, humidity, air quality, etc.) based on measurements, can operate to control building equipment to control the physical building conditions based on masked data. For example, in some embodiments, the cloud entity service **626** receives timeseries data for temperature of a space of a building from a thermostat. PII linked to a thermostat entity representing the thermostat can be the timeseries temperature data. The timeseries temperature data can include both a communications address of the thermostat and a temperature measurement of the thermostat.

(315) In some embodiments, the cloud entity service **626** can provide the temperature timeseries data to the BMS controller **546** in response to receiving a request for the timeseries data and/or data of the thermostat. However, based on a mask and various access values associated with the BMS controller **546**, the cloud entity service **626** can mask the timeseries data such that the thermostat address is removed and only the temperature values are retained. In this regard, the BMS controller **466** can continue to operate the physical conditions of the building but is not exposed to private information of the thermostat.

(316) As another example, a user can be linked to biometric data, the data can include an image of a face and a fingerprint. A facial recognition access system can query the cloud entity service **626** for the biometric data of the user to determine whether to allow the user to enter the building (e.g., operate doors, turn styles, etc.). The cloud entity service **626** can determine, based on a selected mask template, to hide the fingerprint data from the masked data that the cloud entity service **626** provides to the facial recognition access system since the facial recognition access system may only require the facial image of the user and exposing the fingerprint to the user would be providing the facial recognition access system with unnecessary information. Based on the facial image, the facial recognition access system can operate doors, turn styles, etc. when the user is detected. However, for a fingerprint based access system of another building, the cloud entity service **626** can mask the facial image of the user when providing information to the fingerprint based access system.

(317) Furthermore, the masked information generated by the cloud entity service **626** can be provided to end users via user interfaces. For example, a doctor may wish to pull-up personal information for a particular user, e.g., a medical history. The cloud entity service **626** can mask the medical history of the user and provide the history to the doctor via a user device (e.g., a cellphone, a tablet, a laptop, etc.). However, for a school teacher requesting the medical history of the user (e.g., a student), the cloud entity service **626** can provide a masked data structure to a user device of the school teacher that displays the medical history masked. For example, the doctor may gain all access to the medical history of the user

while the school teacher may only gain access to life threatening medical conditions or prescriptions of the student.

Configuration of Exemplary Embodiments

(318) The construction and arrangement of the systems and methods as shown in the various exemplary embodiments are illustrative only. Although only a few embodiments have been described in detail in this disclosure, many modifications are possible (e.g., variations in sizes, dimensions, structures, shapes and proportions of the various elements, values of parameters, mounting arrangements, use of materials, colors, orientations, etc.). For example, the position of elements can be reversed or otherwise varied and the nature or number of discrete elements or positions can be altered or varied. Accordingly, all such modifications are intended to be included within the scope of the present disclosure. The order or sequence of any process or method steps can be varied or re-sequenced according to alternative embodiments. Other substitutions, modifications, changes, and omissions can be made in the design, operating conditions and arrangement of the exemplary embodiments without departing from the scope of the present disclosure.

(319) The present disclosure contemplates methods, systems and program products on any machine-readable media for accomplishing various operations. The embodiments of the present disclosure can be implemented using existing computer processors, or by a special purpose computer processor for an appropriate system, incorporated for this or another purpose, or by a hardwired system. Embodiments within the scope of the present disclosure include program products comprising machine-readable media for carrying or having machine-executable instructions or data structures stored thereon. Such machine-readable media can be any available media that can be accessed by a general purpose or special purpose computer or other machine with a processor. By way of example, such machine-readable media can comprise RAM, ROM, EPROM, EEPROM, CD-ROM or other optical disk storage, magnetic disk storage or other magnetic storage devices, or any other medium which can be used to carry or store desired program code in the form of machine-executable instructions or data structures and which can be accessed by a general purpose or special purpose computer or other machine with a processor. Combinations of the above are also included within the scope of machine-readable media. Machine-executable instructions include, for example, instructions and data which cause a general purpose computer, special purpose computer, or special purpose processing machines to perform a certain function or group of functions.

(320) Although the figures show a specific order of method steps, the order of the steps may differ from what is depicted. Also two or more steps can be performed concurrently or with partial concurrence. Such variation will depend on the software and hardware systems chosen and on designer choice. All such variations are within the scope of the disclosure. Likewise, software implementations could be accomplished with standard programming techniques with rule based logic and other logic to accomplish the various connection steps, processing steps, comparison steps and decision steps.

(321) The term “client” or “server” include all kinds of apparatus, devices, and machines for processing data, including by way of example a programmable processor, a computer, a system on a chip, or multiple ones, or combinations, of the foregoing. The apparatus may include special purpose logic circuitry, e.g., a field programmable gate array (FPGA) or an application specific integrated circuit (ASIC). The apparatus may also include, in addition to hardware, code that creates an execution environment for the computer program in question (e.g., code that constitutes processor firmware, a protocol stack, a database management system, an operating system, a cross-platform runtime environment, a virtual machine, or a combination of one or more of them). The apparatus and execution environment may realize various different computing model infrastructures, such as web services, distributed computing and grid computing infrastructures.

(322) The systems and methods of the present disclosure may be completed by any computer program. A computer program (also known as a program, software, software application, script, or code) may be written in any form of programming language, including compiled or interpreted languages, declarative or procedural languages, and it may be deployed in any form, including as a stand-alone program or as a module, component, subroutine, object, or other unit suitable for use in a computing environment. A computer program may, but need not, correspond to a file in a file system. A program may be stored in a portion of a file that holds other programs or data (e.g., one or more scripts stored in a markup language document), in a single file dedicated to the program in question, or in multiple coordinated files (e.g., files that store one or more modules, sub programs, or portions of code). A computer program may be deployed to be executed on one computer or on multiple computers that are located at one site or distributed across

multiple sites and interconnected by a communication network.

(323) The processes and logic flows described in this specification may be performed by one or more programmable processors executing one or more computer programs to perform actions by operating on input data and generating output. The processes and logic flows may also be performed by, and apparatus may also be implemented as, special purpose logic circuitry (e.g., an FPGA or an ASIC).

(324) Processors suitable for the execution of a computer program include, by way of example, both general and special purpose microprocessors, and any one or more processors of any kind of digital computer. Generally, a processor will receive instructions and data from a read only memory or a random access memory or both. The essential elements of a computer are a processor for performing actions in accordance with instructions and one or more memory devices for storing instructions and data. Generally, a computer will also include, or be operatively coupled to receive data from or transfer data to, or both, one or more mass storage devices for storing data (e.g., magnetic, magneto-optical disks, or optical disks). However, a computer need not have such devices. Moreover, a computer may be embedded in another device (e.g., a mobile telephone, a personal digital assistant (PDA), a mobile audio or video player, a game console, a Global Positioning System (GPS) receiver, or a portable storage device (e.g., a universal serial bus (USB) flash drive), etc.). Devices suitable for storing computer program instructions and data include all forms of non-volatile memory, media and memory devices, including by way of example semiconductor memory devices (e.g., EPROM, EEPROM, and flash memory devices; magnetic disks, e.g., internal hard disks or removable disks; magneto-optical disks; and CD ROM and DVD-ROM disks). The processor and the memory may be supplemented by, or incorporated in, special purpose logic circuitry.

(325) To provide for interaction with a user, implementations of the subject matter described in this specification may be implemented on a computer having a display device (e.g., a CRT (cathode ray tube), LCD (liquid crystal display), OLED (organic light emitting diode), TFT (thin-film transistor), or other flexible configuration, or any other monitor for displaying information to the user and a keyboard, a pointing device, e.g., a mouse, trackball, etc., or a touch screen, touch pad, etc.) by which the user may provide input to the computer. Other kinds of devices may be used to provide for interaction with a user as well; for example, feedback provided to the user may be any form of sensory feedback (e.g., visual feedback, auditory feedback, or tactile feedback), and input from the user may be received in any form, including acoustic, speech, or tactile input. In addition, a computer may interact with a user by sending documents to and receiving documents from a device that is used by the user; for example, by sending web pages to a web browser on a user's client device in response to requests received from the web browser.

(326) Implementations of the subject matter described in this disclosure may be implemented in a computing system that includes a back-end component (e.g., as a data server), or that includes a middleware component (e.g., an application server), or that includes a front end component (e.g., a client computer) having a graphical user interface or a web browser through which a user may interact with an implementation of the subject matter described in this disclosure, or any combination of one or more such back end, middleware, or front end components. The components of the system may be interconnected by any form or medium of digital data communication (e.g., a communication network). Examples of communication networks include a LAN and a WAN, an inter-network (e.g., the Internet), and peer-to-peer networks (e.g., ad hoc peer-to-peer networks).

(327) The present disclosure may be embodied in various different forms, and should not be construed as being limited to only the illustrated embodiments herein. Rather, these embodiments are provided as examples so that this disclosure will be thorough and complete, and will fully convey the aspects and features of the present disclosure to those skilled in the art. Accordingly, processes, elements, and techniques that are not necessary to those having ordinary skill in the art for a complete understanding of the aspects and features of the present disclosure may not be described. Unless otherwise noted, like reference numerals denote like elements throughout the attached drawings and the written description, and thus, descriptions thereof may not be repeated. Further, features or aspects within each example embodiment should typically be considered as available for other similar features or aspects in other example embodiments.

(328) It will be understood that, although the terms “first,” “second,” “third,” etc., may be used herein to describe various elements, components, regions, layers and/or sections, these elements, components, regions, layers and/or sections should not be limited by these terms. These terms are used to distinguish

one element, component, region, layer or section from another element, component, region, layer or section. Thus, a first element, component, region, layer or section described below could be termed a second element, component, region, layer or section, without departing from the spirit and scope of the present disclosure.

(329) The terminology used herein is for the purpose of describing particular embodiments and is not intended to be limiting of the present disclosure. As used herein, the singular forms “a” and “an” are intended to include the plural forms as well, unless the context clearly indicates otherwise. It will be further understood that the terms “comprises,” “comprising,” “includes,” and “including,” “has,” “have,” and “having,” when used in this specification, specify the presence of the stated features, integers, steps, operations, elements, and/or components, but do not preclude the presence or addition of one or more other features, integers, steps, operations, elements, components, and/or groups thereof. As used herein, the term “and/or” includes any and all combinations of one or more of the associated listed items. Expressions such as “at least one of,” when preceding a list of elements, modify the entire list of elements and do not modify the individual elements of the list.

(330) As used herein, the term “substantially,” “about,” and similar terms are used as terms of approximation and not as terms of degree, and are intended to account for the inherent variations in measured or calculated values that would be recognized by those of ordinary skill in the art. Further, the use of “may” when describing embodiments of the present disclosure refers to “one or more embodiments of the present disclosure.” As used herein, the terms “use,” “using,” and “used” may be considered synonymous with the terms “utilize,” “utilizing,” and “utilized,” respectively. Also, the term “exemplary” is intended to refer to an example or illustration.

(331) A portion of the disclosure of this patent document contains material which is subject to copyright protection. The copyright owner has no objection to the facsimile reproduction by anyone of the patent document or the patent disclosure, as it appears in the Patent and Trademark Office patent file or records, but otherwise reserves all copyright rights whatsoever.

Claims

1. A building system of a building comprising: one or more storage media storing instructions thereon that, when executed by one or more processors, cause the one or more processors to: store at least one digital twin in the one or more storage media, the at least one digital twin including personal identifying information (PII) associated with a user and an indication that a security device has access to the PII; receive a request from the security device for the PII for the user, wherein the security device performs one or more security functions for the building; determine, based on the at least one digital twin, that the security device has access to the PII associated with the user; and provide the PII associated with the user to the security device.
2. The building system of claim 1, wherein the instructions cause the one or more processors to: identify, based on the at least one digital twin, that the security device performs the one or more security functions for the user; and determine that the security device has access to the PII for the user responsive to an identification that the security device performs the one or more security functions for the user.
3. The building system of claim 1, wherein the at least one digital twin includes representations of: the user and relationships between the security device, the user, and the PII associated with the user.
4. The building system of claim 1, wherein the security device is an access control device that controls access of the user to a space of the building; wherein the instructions cause the one or more processors to: identify, based on the at least one digital twin, that the access control device provides the user access to the space; and determine, based on the at least one digital twin, that the access control device has access to the PII associated with the user responsive to an identification that the access control device provides the user access to the space.
5. The building system of claim 1, wherein the instructions cause the one or more processors to: determine, based on the at least one digital twin, that the security device has access to the PII associated with the user by: identifying that an entity of the building represented by a first digital twin of the at least one digital twin has access to the PII; identifying that a second digital twin of the at least one digital twin representing the security device is related via a relationship to the first digital twin; and determining that the security

device that the security device has access to the PII associated with the user based on identifying that the second digital twin is related via the relationship to the first digital twin.

6. The building system of claim 5, wherein the entity of the building is another security device of the building.

7. The building system of claim 1, wherein the at least one digital twin include a first digital twin representing the security device and a second digital twin representing the PII; wherein the instructions cause the one or more processors to: infer a relationship between the first digital twin and the second digital twin based on a plurality of other relationships of a plurality of digital twins, wherein the relationship inferred between the first digital twin and the second digital twin indicates that the security device performs the one or more security functions associated with the user.

8. The building system of claim 7, wherein the instructions cause the one or more processors to: infer the relationship inferred between the first digital twin and the second digital twin by determining a transitive closure for the plurality of digital twins.

9. The building system of claim 1, wherein the instructions cause the one or more processors to: receive, from the security device, access values; retrieve, from the at least one digital twin, a mask template from a plurality of mask templates based on the access values, the plurality of mask templates being data structures indicating different types of masking for the PII; and generate a masked information data structure based on private information and the mask template; and provide the masked information data structure to the security device.

10. The building system of claim 9, wherein the instructions cause the one or more processors to: select the mask template from the plurality of mask templates by selecting the mask template from the plurality of mask templates as a function of the access values.

11. The building system of claim 9, wherein each of the plurality of mask templates is associated with a particular combination of values of the access values; wherein the instructions cause the one or more processors to: select the mask template from the plurality of mask templates by selecting the mask template based on the particular combination of values of the access values by identifying the mask template of the plurality of mask templates associated with the particular combination of values of the access values.

12. The building system of claim 9, wherein each of the plurality of mask templates comprises a plurality of masking operators wherein the plurality of masking operators comprise at least one of: a first masking operator configured to replace one or more values of the PII with a particular masking character; a second masking operator configured to show the PII in the clear; a third masking operator configured to show only a particular number of a plurality of values of the PII; or a fourth masking operator configured to apply a particular encryption method on the PII.

13. The building system of claim 9, wherein the access values comprise at least one of: a type of the security device; a geographic location of the security device; an application of the security device associated with generating the request for the PII; or a vertical identifying a business use associated with the security device.

14. The building system of claim 9, wherein the instructions cause the one or more processors to generate an access hash key based on the access values; wherein the instructions cause the one or more processors to select the mask template from the plurality of mask templates from a plurality of digital twins based on the access values by selecting the mask template from the plurality of mask templates with the access hash key, wherein each of the plurality of mask templates is associated with a particular value of the access hash key.

15. The building system of claim 14, wherein the instructions cause the one or more processors to generate the access hash key by concatenating the access values and hashing the access values concatenated to generate the access hash key.

16. A method, comprising: storing, by one or more processing circuits, at least one digital twin in the one or more storage media, the at least one digital twin including personal identifying information (PII) associated with a user and an indication that a security device has access to the PII; receiving, by the one or more processing circuits, a request from the security device for the PII for the user, wherein the security device performs one or more security functions for the building; determining, by the one or more processing circuits, based on the at least one digital twin, that the security device has access to the PII for the user; and providing, by the one or more processing circuits, the PII for the user to the security device.

17. The method of claim 16, comprising: identifying, by the one or more processing circuits, based on the at least one digital twin, that the security device performs the one or more security functions associated with the user; and determining, by the one or more processing circuits, that the security device has access to the PII for the user responsive to an identification that the security device performs the one or more security functions.

18. The method of claim 16, wherein the at least one digital twin includes representations of: the user, relationships between the security device, the user, and the PII associated with the user.

19. The method of claim 16, wherein the security device is an access control device that controls access of the user to a space of the building; wherein the method comprising: identifying, by the one or more processing circuits, based on the at least one digital twin, that the access control device provides the user access to the space; and determining, by the one or more processing circuits, based on the at least one digital twin, that the access control device has access to the PII for the user responsive to an identification that the access control device provides the user access to the space.

20. One or more storage media storing instructions thereon that, when executed by one or more processors, cause the one or more processors to: store at least one digital twin in the one or more storage media, the at least one digital twin including personal identifying information (PII) associated with a user and an indication that a security device has access to the PII; receive a request from the security device for the PII for the user, wherein the security device performs one or more security functions for the building; determine, based on the at least one digital twin, that the security device has access to the PII for the user; and provide the PII for the user to the security device.
